

October 2025

UVU

Active Transportation Plan

PREPARED BY: BikeUtah

Table of Contents

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

01 Introduction 04

How to Use This Plan 05
Design Principles 06
Goals, Objectives, and Policies 07
Benefits of Active Transportation 11

02 Community Profile 12

Utah Valley University 13
Commuting Patterns 14
Community Engagement 15

03 Existing Conditions 20

Present State 21
Commuting to Campus 22
Traveling on Campus 29
Current and Future Land Use 34

04 Facility Recommendations 36

Summary 37
UVU Bike Loop 39
UVU Bike Loop Conflict Points 43
Multi-Use Paths 45
Multi-Use Paths Conflict Points 45
Bike Racks 60
Wayfinding 68
Comfort improvements 72

05 Implementation Plan 85

Coordination with Stakeholders 86
Implementation Timeline 87
Policies and Programs 88
Maintenance Guidelines 89
Funding Sources 90

Acknowledgments

Thank you to stakeholders and the public for providing feedback through surveys, interviews, and community workshops throughout this planning process.

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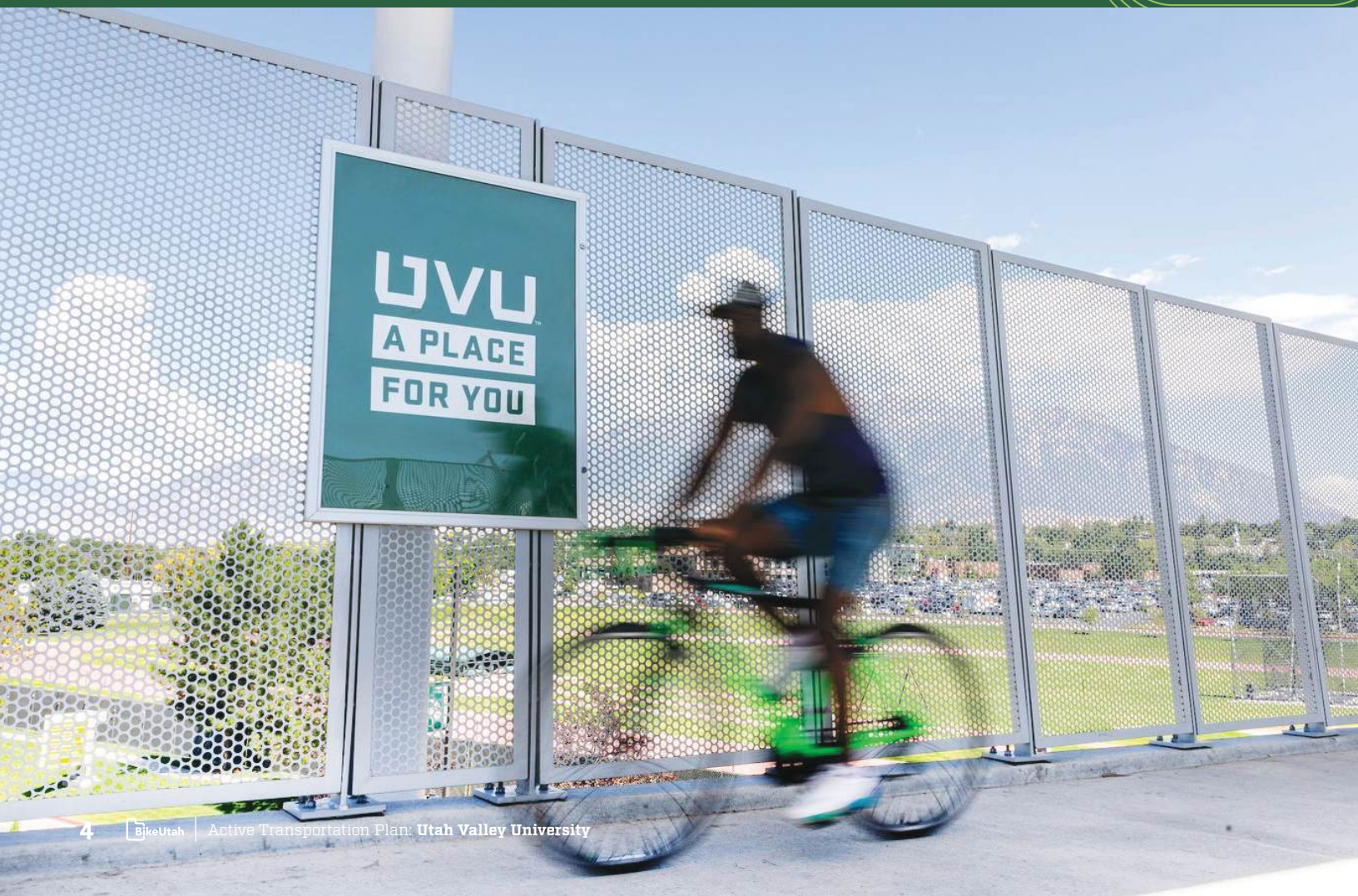
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CHAPTER

01 Introduction



How To Use This Plan

Purpose

This Active Transportation Plan provides infrastructure and facility recommendations to support walking and biking at Utah Valley University. It is intended to support UVU staff, city planners, regional governments, and other stakeholders to create a safer and more connected campus environment.



Scope

This plan focuses on UVU's main campus in Orem, as well as surrounding active transportation connections within 0.5 miles of campus. It addresses walking and biking infrastructure (sidewalks, paths, bike lanes, crossings) as well as supports facilities and policies (bike racks, wayfinding).

Outline

Chapter 02 provides a community profile for UVU, including student demographics, commuting patterns, and insights gathered through stakeholder and community engagement.

Chapter 03 summarizes existing conditions, identifying barriers and opportunities related to commuting to campus, traveling within campus, and current and future land use.

Chapter 04 provides recommendations to improve active transportation, including the UVU Bike Loop, multi-use paths, bike racks, comfort enhancements, and wayfinding.

Chapter 05 outlines an implementation plan with phased priorities, and potential funding strategies to support project delivery.

Design Principles

Successful active transportation networks must be safe, comfortable, useful, and interesting: these **four principles** are embedded throughout this plan's analysis and recommendations.



Safe

Minimize collision risk by separating paths and reducing conflict points



Comfortable

Enhance user experience through smooth routes and street amenities



Useful

Prioritize practical and direct routes to essential destinations



Interesting

Provide friendly streets with unique buildings and engaging spaces

Goals, Objectives, and Policies

DEFINITIONS

Goals
Broad statements that define long-term community outcomes.

Objectives
Specific steps within the plan that contribute to achieving these goals.

Policies
Actions to support these goals and objectives after plan implementation.

Goal 1: Improve safety for people who walk, bike, and roll on campus



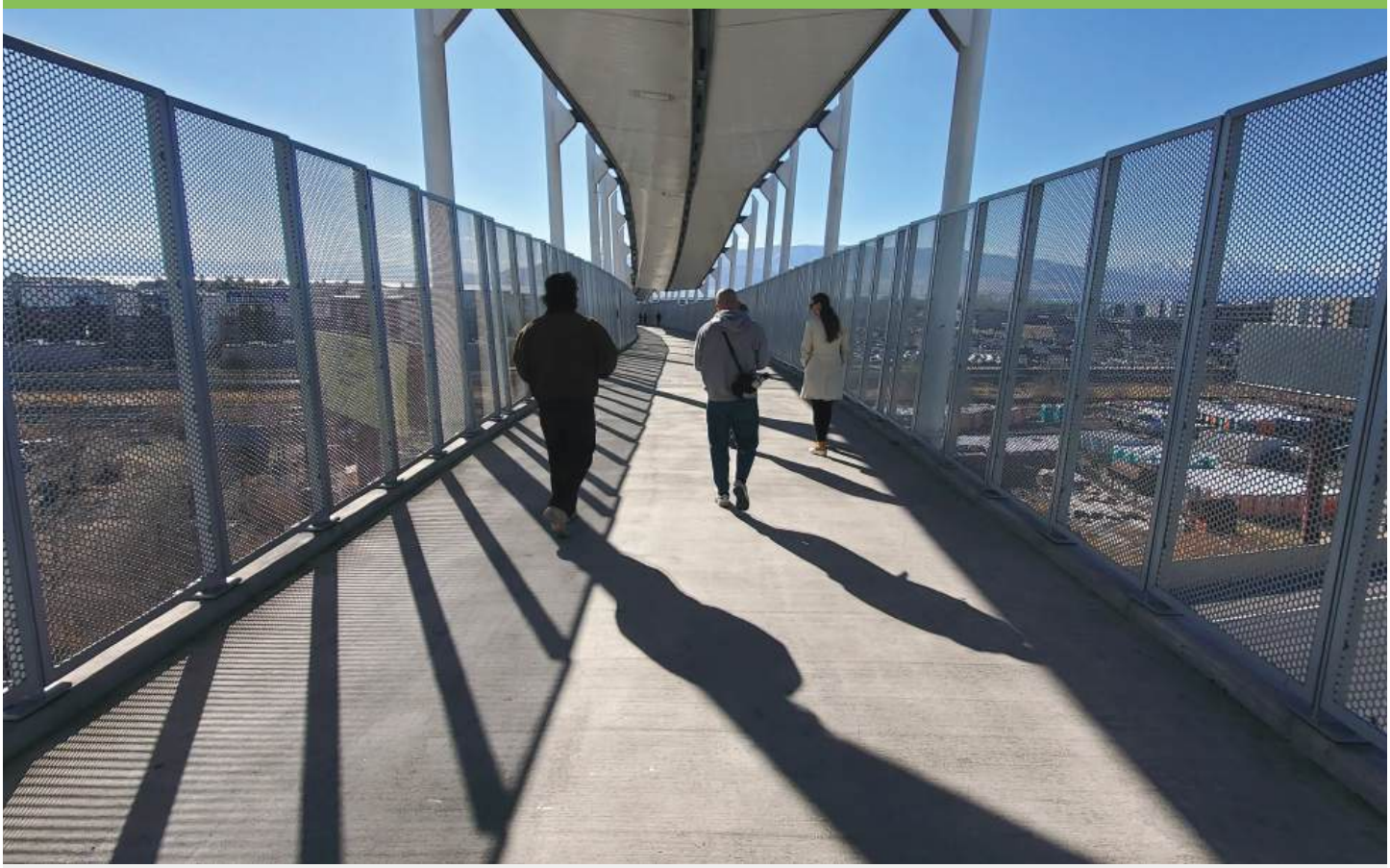
Objectives

1. Identify areas with high risk of injuries and fatalities
2. Provide high comfort, high safety recommendations that separate AT users and vehicles
3. Provide high quality crossing recommendations across barrier roads and highways
4. Provide adequate lighting recommendations for all AT paths on campus
5. Monitor interactions between pedestrians, bicyclists, and other users of micro mobility devices to update regulations for devices on campus.

Policies

- Fund and maintain high-quality walking and biking paths and crossings
- Monitor pedestrian and cyclist collision levels and address issues as needed
- Develop campus programs to improve campus safety and security, especially at night

Goal 2: Improve connectivity to neighboring active transportation networks



Objectives

1. Identify surrounding active transportation networks
2. Ensure recommendations provide continuous connections between campus paths and surrounding active transportation facilities
3. Provide clear wayfinding recommendations to and from nearby destinations

Policies

- Update this plan periodically to align with neighboring city plans and development
- Coordinate with surrounding cities on implementation of this plan
- Create an Active Transportation Advisory Committee to coordinate and advise on campus active transportation issues

Goal 3: Promote active transportation to and from campus



Objectives

1. Ensure recommendations provide convenient walking and biking paths to major campus destinations and surrounding neighborhoods
2. Provide AT amenity recommendations including secure bike parking, bike repair stations, and shade structures on campus
3. Provide guidance to ensure paths are well maintained, especially during winter
4. Develop campus messaging that highlights the benefit of walking and biking
5. Develop incentives for students who walk or bike to campus

Policies

- Undertake routine maintenance including path sweeping and snow removal as needed
- Ensure bike parking with lighting and surveillance is included when new buildings are constructed
- Develop campus programs to promote and incentivize active transportation

Active



Downtown Salt Lake City, 2012. Photo by The Salt Lake Tribune.

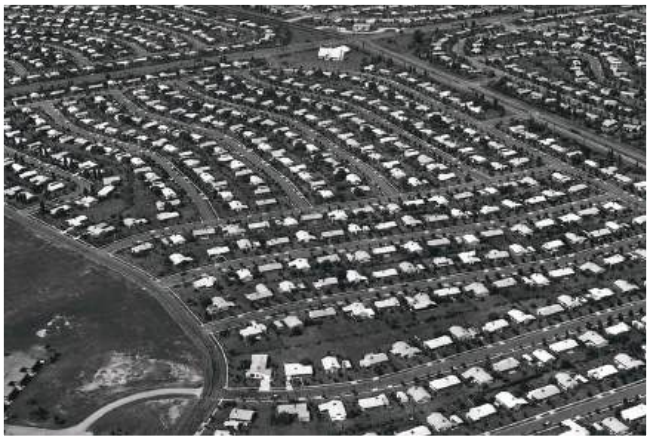
Traditional Urban Form

Traditional American cities were designed to be walkable. Streets were narrow, destinations were close, and walking or biking was the default way to access daily needs. This traditional development pattern supported local businesses and vibrant neighborhoods, encouraged social interaction, and promoted active lifestyles.

Suburban Rise

Since the 1950s, however, car-centric planning has gradually replaced this walkable development style with wide, high-speed roads, expansive parking lots, and disconnected land uses that make active transportation difficult.

The early development of Utah Valley University reflects some of these suburban influences. The campus is located along I-15 and connected to high-speed arterials such as University Parkway, emphasizing regional automobile access for commuting students. These surroundings present unique challenges for improving active transportation to and around the university.



Wikimedia Commons — Levittown, PA (accessed Oct. 2025)



American Heritage Center (University of Wyoming), image "ah002532," accessed via ahcwyo.

Walkability on Campus

College campuses are generally among the most walkable places within modern cities. UVU follows this pattern, featuring compact, pedestrian-oriented buildings organized around central plazas and limited vehicle access. Despite being surrounded by car-oriented roadways, the campus itself supports convenient, safe, and active movement by foot and bicycle.

Protecting and enhancing walkability is essential to maintaining the accessibility, safety, and vibrancy of campus life. Active transportation directly supports UVU's mission to provide a welcoming environment and high-quality student experience.

Benefits of Active Transportation

Walkability is fundamental to the campus experience. When walking and biking is accessible, students arrive to class **less stressed** and **more focused**. People spend more time outside, meet each other in passing, and experience the campus as a shared space. These seemingly small daily experiences shape a university's culture, community, and sense of belonging.



CAMPUSES THAT PRIORITIZE ACTIVE TRANSPORTATION BENEFIT IN MANY WAYS:

Health:

Walking and biking are easy, affordable ways for students and staff to stay physically active, contributing to better physical and mental health outcomes and overall well being.

Mobility:

Not all students can or want to drive. A well-connected walking and biking network ensures independence and accessibility for all.

Affordability:

Driving is expensive. Nationally, the average cost of driving a car exceeds $12,000 per year. Convenient walking and biking paths allow students and staff to spend less on transportation costs.

Safety:

Active transportation infrastructure is shown to significantly improve road safety, especially when vehicles are physically separated from vulnerable road users. Crossings and traffic calming infrastructure improve safety by encouraging more cautious driving behaviors and reduced speeds.

Environment:

Walking and biking reduce vehicle emissions, which are a major source of air pollution in Utah. Active transportation also reduces noise pollution and lowers demand for paved surfaces, preserving green space and minimizing stormwater runoff.

Campus Experience:

College campuses that are designed for walking and biking feel more welcoming, social, and vibrant. These characteristics improve student retention and recruitment.

CHAPTER

02 Community Profile



Utah Valley University

Active Transportation at UVU

Utah Valley University (UVU) is the **largest public university in Utah**, enrolling nearly 45,000 students in 2023. Originally established in 1941 as Central Utah Vocational School, UVU has undergone significant transformation over the decades. Its evolution from a technical school to a state college to a full-fledged university mirrors the rapid growth in Utah County and increasing demand for higher education.

UVU's main campus is located in Orem and serves as the university's academic and administrative core. Additionally, UVU operates satellite campuses in Lehi, Provo, and Heber. Future satellite campuses may be developed in Vineyard and Payson. Today, UVU stands not only as an educational hub but also as a major economic and cultural driver for the region. **The university employs more than 5,000 faculty and staff, making it one of the largest employers in Utah County.** UVU often partners with local governments and organizations to host conferences and community events.

Utah Valley University is a commuter campus with no on-campus housing, although many students live in nearby apartments that functionally serve as student housing. Others commute from surrounding communities across Utah County and beyond.

The campus is strategically located adjacent to UTA's Orem Central Station (FrontRunner) and the UVX UVU Station, providing strong regional transit connections. Several local bus routes also serve the university. These transit options are support by a university-funded program to provide UTA passes to all students, faculty, and staff.



FrontRunner train in Orem.
(Photo: Lee Davidson, The Salt Lake Tribune)



UVX BRT station design.
(Image: PIVOT Architecture)

Within this context, active transportation plays a critical role in campus mobility. Walking and biking offer flexible, affordable, and convenient travel options to regional transit lines and nearby neighborhoods. As the university and the region grow, investments in active transportation will be essential to reduce congestion, improve safety, and support a more connected and vibrant campus environment.

UVU in 2025:

48,670
Students



6,070
Faculty and Staff



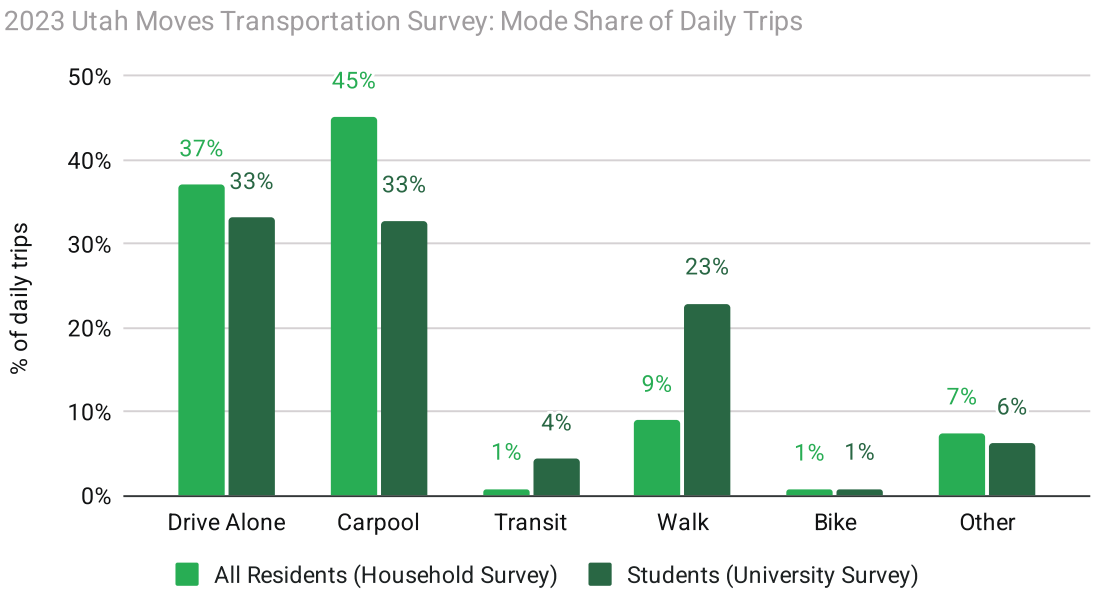


UVU: One of Utah County's Largest Employers



Commuting Patterns

Commuting Patterns: Utah Residents vs University Students (statewide)



Active Transportation is Growing, But Biking Lags at Universities Statewide

Although precise mode share data for UVU is not available, state data from the 2023 Utah Moves Transportation Survey provides some useful insights.

University students are far more likely than the general population to walk or take transit, with walking accounting for 23% of their daily trips compared to just 9%. Transit use is also four times higher among students (4% vs. 1%). Meanwhile, rates of driving alone and carpooling are lower among students than among Utah residents overall.

Despite most Utah universities providing UTA-funded transit passes and being well connected to transit, over 60% of university student trips statewide occur by car. Biking remains underutilized, representing less than 1% of student trips, pointing to potential barriers and unmet demand for safer, more convenient cycling infrastructure.

These patterns underscore the importance of a transportation network that supports walking, biking, and transit. As enrollment grows and parking constraints intensify, improving active transportation connections will be essential to maintaining access, reducing congestion, and promoting a more sustainable campus environment.

Community Engagement

This plan is grounded in feedback and insights from community stakeholders, students, faculty, and staff. Community engagement activities included:

- **MONTHLY STAKEHOLDER MEETINGS**
  Bike Utah staff met frequently with staff from UVU, Orem City, and the Mountainland Association of Governments (MAG). These meetings updated stakeholders on the plan's progress and ensured alignment between all parties.

- **CAMPUS WALKING TOUR**
  On February 26th, Bike Utah staff joined UVU staff (Sarah Bateman, Kim Reynolds) for a walking tour of campus. This tour highlighted existing AT barriers and opportunities for improvement.

- **COMMUNITY WORKSHOP**
  Bike Utah and stakeholders hosted a public workshop on April 9th at the Sorensen Student Center on campus. This workshop included a presentation about this plan, an open discussion, and an interactive mapping exercise to gather location-specific feedback. Participants identified safety concerns, infrastructure gaps, and ideas for improving AT access and safety.

- **COMMUNITY SURVEY**
  Bike Utah and stakeholders distributed an online survey to collect additional feedback about transportation habits, concerns, and priorities. This survey was open from April 9th to June 18th and was distributed via email through stakeholder newsletters.

- **INTERCEPT SURVEYS**
  In order to gather additional information and verify responses from the previous engagement methods, Bike Utah collected on-the-spot feedback by approaching people on campus and asking them a series of questions. The intercept survey explored how people travel to UVU, why they choose their mode, and potential improvements. It gathered input on commute impact, interest in switching to active or public transit, and suggestions for making active transportation more convenient and appealing.



2025 UVU Active Transportation Plan Workshop

- **COLLABORATION WITH UVU CAMPAIGNS CLASS**
  Bike Utah partnered with Dr. Meghana Rawat's Campaigns course at UVU to spearhead student-led outreach in support of this planning process. Working collaboratively, students conducted a comparative analysis of how other universities communicate AT initiatives, using that research to develop tailored messaging strategies for the UVU community. Their efforts included organizing focus groups to gather student preferences and insights and participating in UVU's active transportation plan open house where students helped provide and collect direct feedback on campus mobility needs. Students also coordinated with local media to advertise the planning effort.

Engagement Findings

The **community workshop, online survey, and intercept surveys** provided valuable insights into transportation and mobility challenges within the study area. Feedback gathered through these engagement methods has been organized into the following categories to inform the recommendations within chapters 4 and 5 of this plan.

Walking

- **LIGHTING**
  Lighting in pedestrian tunnels and at bus stops is dim, cold in tone, and prone to flickering, contributing to a perception of insecurity.
- **GREEN SPACE**
  There is a need for expanded and diversified green spaces, including additional shade trees, landscaping, and plant variety, to improve pedestrian comfort.
- **ADA ACCESSIBLE**
  ADA accessibility concerns include inconsistent elevator maintenance, a lack of curb-cut opportunities, and uneven or deteriorating pavement conditions.

Biking

- **NETWORK GAPS**
  The campus bicycle network is fragmented, with significant connectivity gaps.
- **UNSAFE ROUTES**
  Several routes, particularly those traversing parking areas (such as between the pedestrian bridge and library), are unsafe and inconvenient. The bicycle lane along Campus Drive is narrow, poorly maintained, and prone to debris accumulation, creating safety hazards.
- **UPHILL OBSTACLES**
  Steep grades and stairways on the east side of campus create an uncomfortable and challenging experience for cyclists.
- **BIKE PARKING**
  Bicycle parking infrastructure requires improvement to ensure designs are safe, intuitive, and located in highly visible, convenient areas distributed throughout campus.
- **ROUTE CLARITY**
  Wayfinding for cyclists needs to be enhanced, including updated, legible maps of the bike network and parking facilities.

Pedestrian Bridge



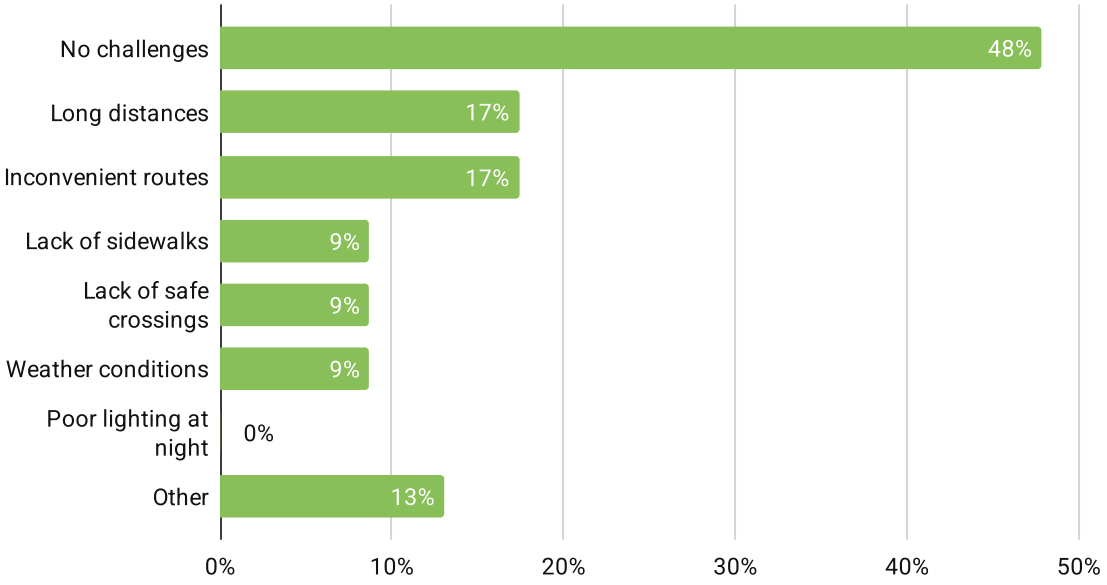
- **BRIDGE WOES**
  The pedestrian bridge environment is noisy, poorly maintained (particularly the elevator), and visually unappealing.
- **NOT BIKE-FRIENDLY**
  Bike wheel gutters are impractical due to insufficient clearance between the gutter and railing.
- **ELEVATORS BROKEN**
  Elevators are frequently out of service, creating a challenge particularly for heavy e-bikes.

Public Transit
(Bus/FrontRunner)

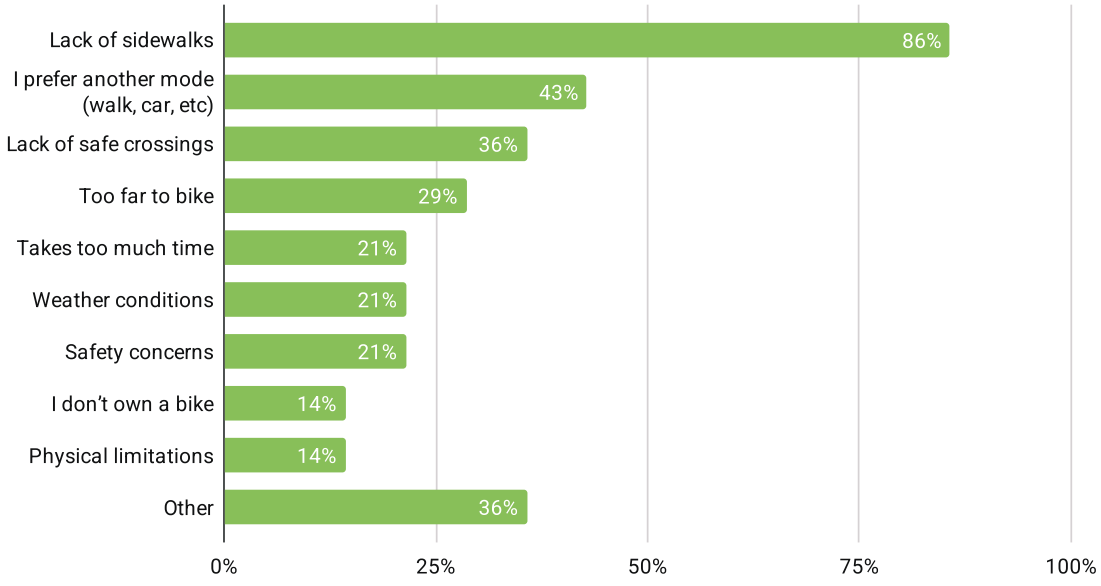


- **TRANSFER TROUBLE**
  Bus transfers and connections are frequently unreliable, with inconsistent and unclear wait times.
- **ROUTE GAPS**
  Existing bus routes have limitied coverage in neighborhoods north the university (Alpine, Cedar Hills, Lindon)
- **SPARSE SERVICE**
  Service frequencies, particularly during off-peak hours, are too infrequent to support reliable, all-day use.
- **EARLY CUTOFF**
  Evening service ends prematurely, limiting travel options for students and community members remaining on or near campus after regular hours.
- **STATION STRUGGLES**
  Station amenities are inadequate, with poor lighting, limited seating, minimal shade, and environments that feel uninviting and unsafe.
- **INFO LACKING**
  Wayfinding resources — including network maps at stops, stations, and online — are insufficient. Riders report difficulty accessing accurate, real-time information and navigating the system.

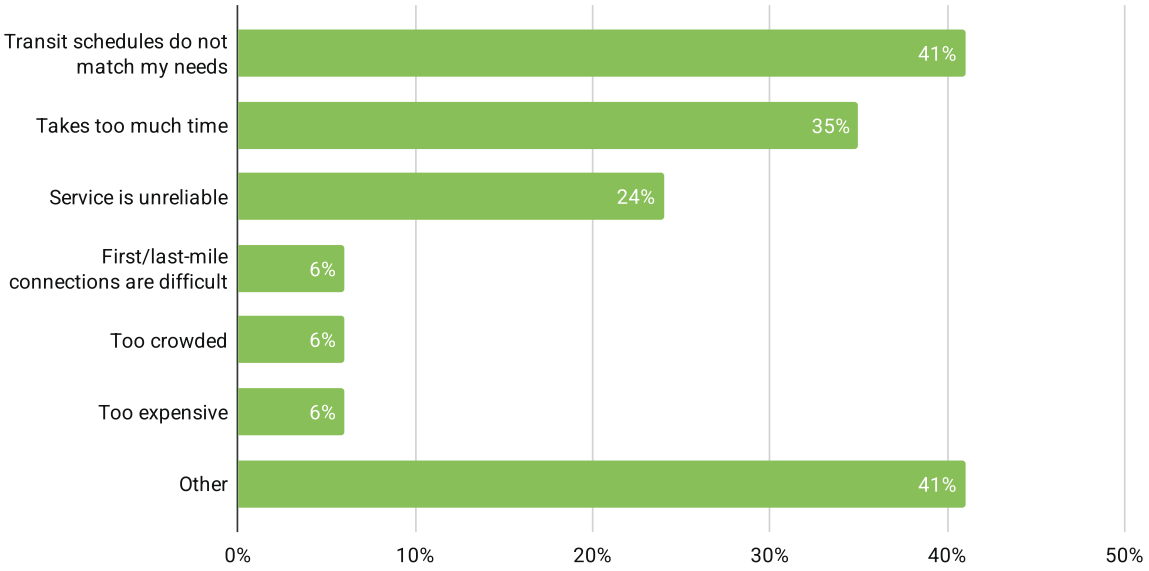
What challenges do you face when walking on campus?



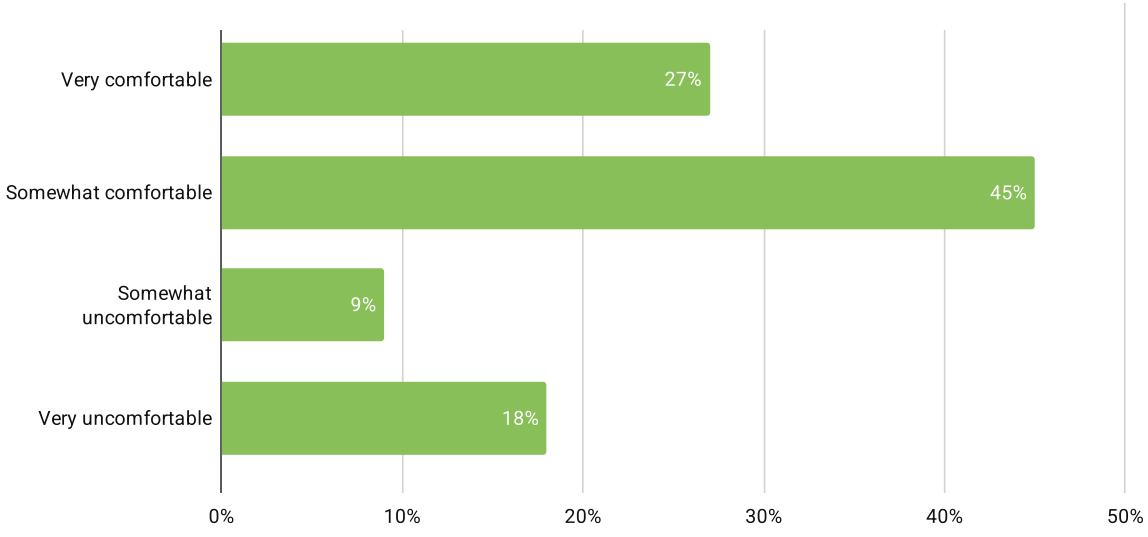
What are your reasons for not biking to/from campus?



What challenges do you face when taking public transit to/from Campus?



How would you rate your experience when using the pedestrian bridge?



CHAPTER

03 Existing Conditions



Present State

Existing Framework

This chapter establishes a baseline for current transportation conditions and land use at and around UVU. In doing so, this chapter identifies barriers and opportunities to active transportation that will be addressed in this plan's recommendations.

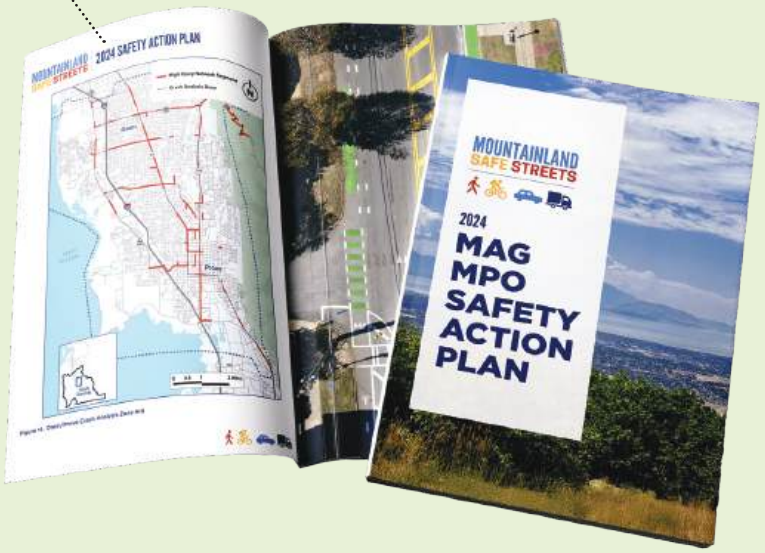
THIS CHAPTER IS DIVIDED INTO THREE SECTIONS:

1 **Commuting to Campus:**
Examines **infrastructure within a half-mile of campus**, evaluating the safety, comfort, and convenience of walking, biking, and using transit to reach UVU.

2 **Traveling on Campus:**
Examines **infrastructure within campus boundaries,** identifying existing AT facilities and barriers.

3 **Current and Future Land Use:**
Examines **existing and planned campus buildings and open space** given that land use directly impacts AT facility placement and transportation behavior.

MAG Safety Action Plan



Integrated Insights

Insights from local and regional plans are integrated into this chapter to ensure consistency and alignment across planning efforts.

THIS INCLUDES:

UVU
- UVU Facilities Master Plan (2021)
- UVU Sustainability Plan (2021)
- UVU Area Transportation Study (2019)

MAG
- MAG Safety Action Plan (2023)
- MAG Strategic Transportation Safety Plan (2021)

VINEYARD
- Vineyard City Active Transportation Plan (2025)

OREM
- Orem City Parks, Recreation, Trails, and Open Space Master Plan (2017)
- Orem City Transportation Plan (2022)

Commuting To Campus

For active transportation to be a viable and attractive mode of travel, **routes to campus must be safe, comfortable, and convenient for pedestrians and cyclists**. This section evaluates the surrounding road network, transit network, and walking/biking routes. This data helps us understand existing conditions that shape commuting behavior and also identifies areas for improvement.

SURROUNDING ROAD NETWORK

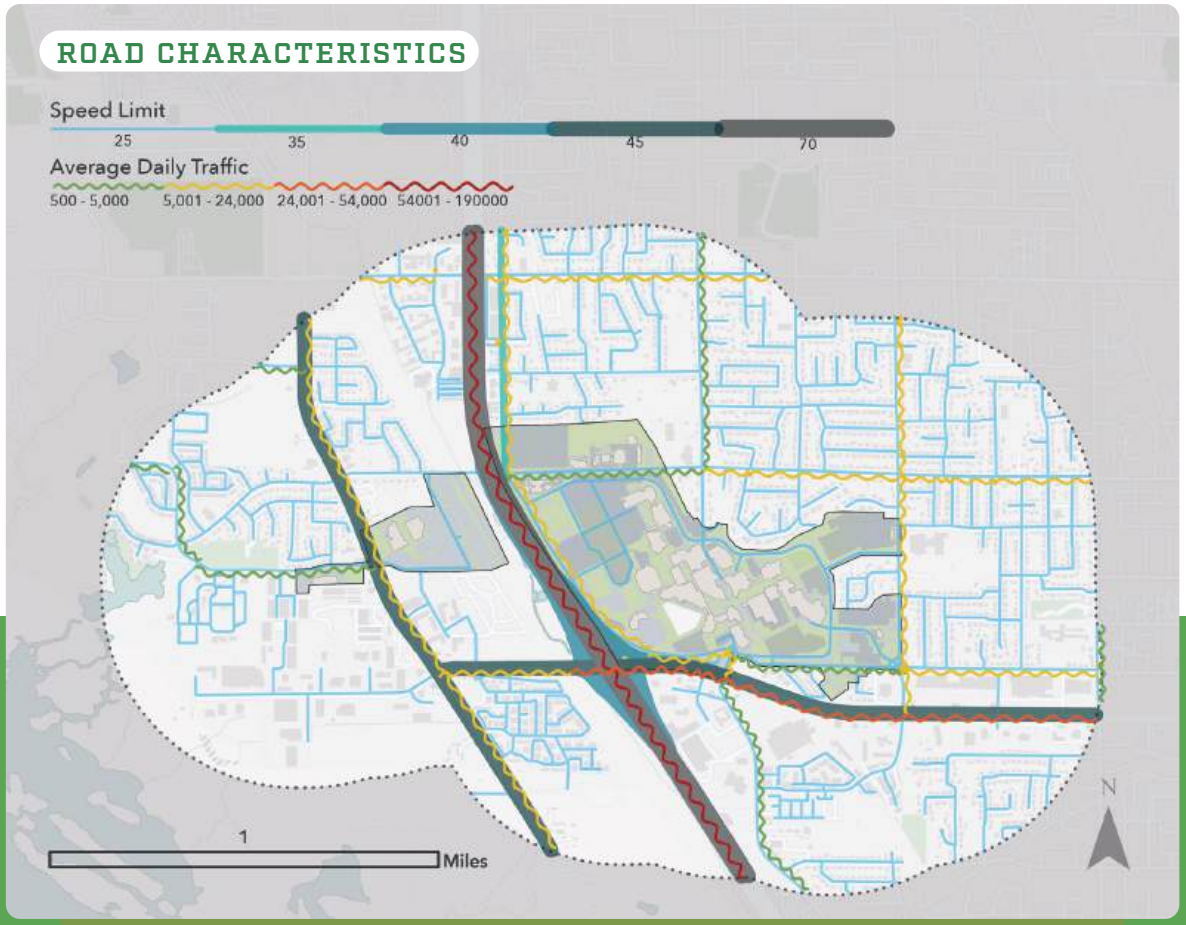
Road Characteristics

- **UNIVERSITY PARKWAY**
  University Parkway is the most significant barrier to active transportation in the study area. With traffic volumes exceeding 53,000 vehicles per day and a 45 mph speed limit, it presents major safety and comfort challenges for people walking or biking. The nearby I-15 interchange further contributes to this hostile environment. Three underpasses offer grade-separated crossings, though wayfinding along these routes is limited.

- **GENEVA ROAD**
  Geneva Road, also posted at 45 mph, carries approximately 13,000 vehicles per day. While less congested than University Parkway, it still presents a considerable safety challenge due to its speed and vehicle volumes, particularly at intersections and crossings.

- **SANDHILL ROAD**
  Sandhill Road, while posted at 25 mph, carries moderately high traffic volumes, particularly around the roundabout just north of University Parkway. Its role as a key north-south connector increases its importance in the local network and elevates the need for pedestrian and bicycle safety treatments.

- **SEVERAL NEIGHBORHOOD STREETS**
  Including 800 South, 1200 West, and 400 West—also show moderately high AADT levels, with 800 South carrying up to 9,000 vehicles per day. While these streets are generally lower-speed, their traffic volumes warrant careful consideration to preserve safe and comfortable conditions for active travel.

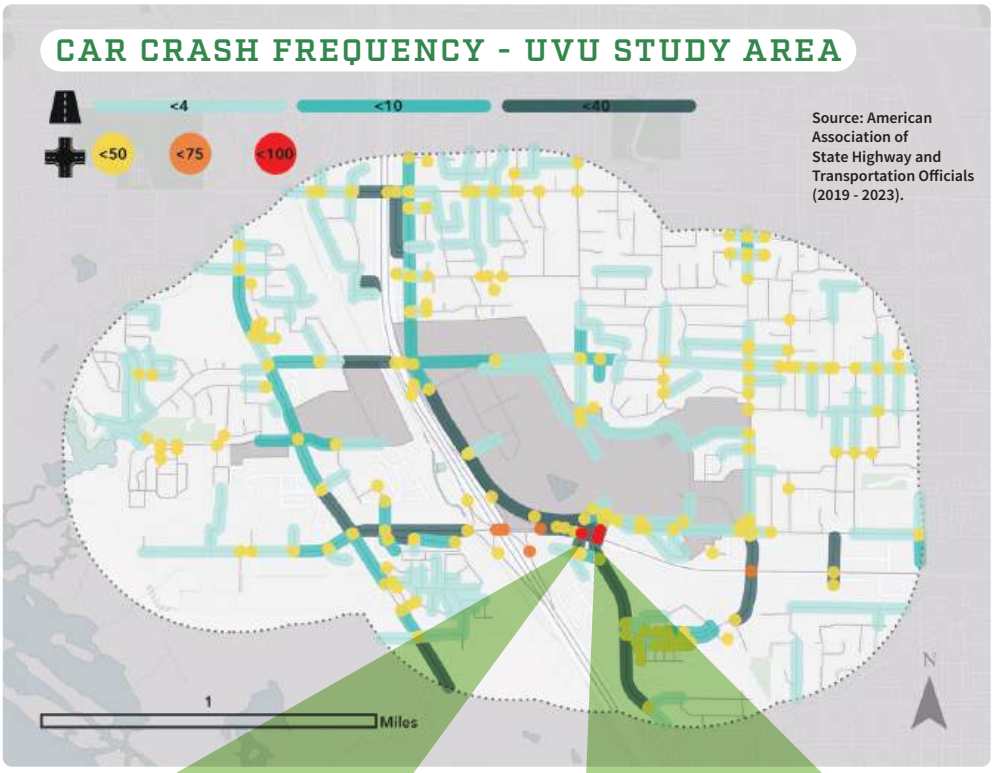


Car Crash Frequency

- **COLLEGE DRIVE**
  College Drive has a high crash frequency despite relatively low traffic volumes and speeds.

- **UNIVERSITY PARKWAY**
  University Parkway has high crash frequency, especially near the I-15 interchange.

- **SANDHILL ROAD**
  Sandhill Road also has high crash frequency, particularly at the intersection with University Parkway and the roundabout at College Drive. Both sites serve as important access points to campus and would benefit from targeted safety improvements.





UNIVERSITY PARKWAY

This 11-lane road has a 45 mph speed limit and 53k AADT. This road is very unsafe and uncomfortable for pedestrians and cyclists.



ROUNDABOUT AT SANDHILL ROAD AND CAMPUS DRIVE:

These road segments lack sidewalks, bike lanes, and crossings.

Planned Road Improvements

The UVU Area Transportation Study (2019) evaluated traffic circulation and transportation needs around the UVU campus. While not all recommendations are advancing, the proposed projects would have substantial impacts on local mobility.

We recommend active transportation elements such as bike facilities, sidewalks, and traffic calming be integrated into each project as they move forward.

RELEVANT PROJECTS INCLUDE:



I-15 Northbound Off-Ramp to Campus Drive

I-15 Northbound Off-Ramp to Campus Drive

A proposed grade-separated off-ramp would allow northbound traffic to exit I-15 directly onto Campus Drive, improving access to UVU and reducing congestion on University Parkway.

Sandhill Road Grade Separation

A long-term project that would carry University Parkway traffic over Sandhill Road, improving traffic flow and reducing conflict points at this busy intersection.



Sandhill Road Grade Separation



800 South Improvements

800 South Improvements

Plans include a new roundabout near UVU parking lots to improve access and circulation.

SURROUNDING AT NETWORK

Existing and Proposed Bike Routes

The *Orem City Parks, Recreation, Trails, and Open Space Master Plan (2017)* outlines existing and proposed bike paths throughout the city, shown in the tables below.

The ***Vineyard City Active Transportation Plan (2025)*** recommends a new multi-use path along Geneva Road, from 1600 North to 400 North. This project would address a significant infrastructure gap and offer a safer, more comfortable route to UVU from the west.



- Blue ..... **Bike lane**
- Purple ..... **Multi-use path**
- Green ..... **Bike route (sharrow)**
- Yellow ..... **Bike boulevard (traffic calming)**

Source: Pedestrian and Bike Paths, Orem City Transportation Plan (2020)

Existing Bike Routes

Street	Facility Type	Missing Segments
1200 W	Bike lane	None
800 W	Bike lane	None
400 W	Bike lane	Missing between 800 S and 1200 S
800 S	Bike lane	North of campus between 1200 W and 800 W
1200 S	Bike lane	Ends at 400 W roundabout
Campus Drive	Bike lane	North and south segments near intersections

Proposed Bike Routes

Street	Facility Type
400 S	Bike lane
College Drive	Bike lane
Sandhill Road	Bike lane/ multi-use path
1000 S (Utah Lake Shoreline Trail Access)	Multi-use path
Rail Trail	Multi-use path
Geneva Road	Multi Use Path

Existing Bike Routes



Geneva Road

This 5-lane road has a 45mph speed limit and 13K AADT. The buffered bike lane provides an important bike route, but only for a small segment of this road.



College Connector Trail

Adjacent to University Parkway in Orem



1200 South

Bike lanes end at the roundabout at 400 W



Campus Drive

Bike lanes and a pedestrian crossing with RRFBs

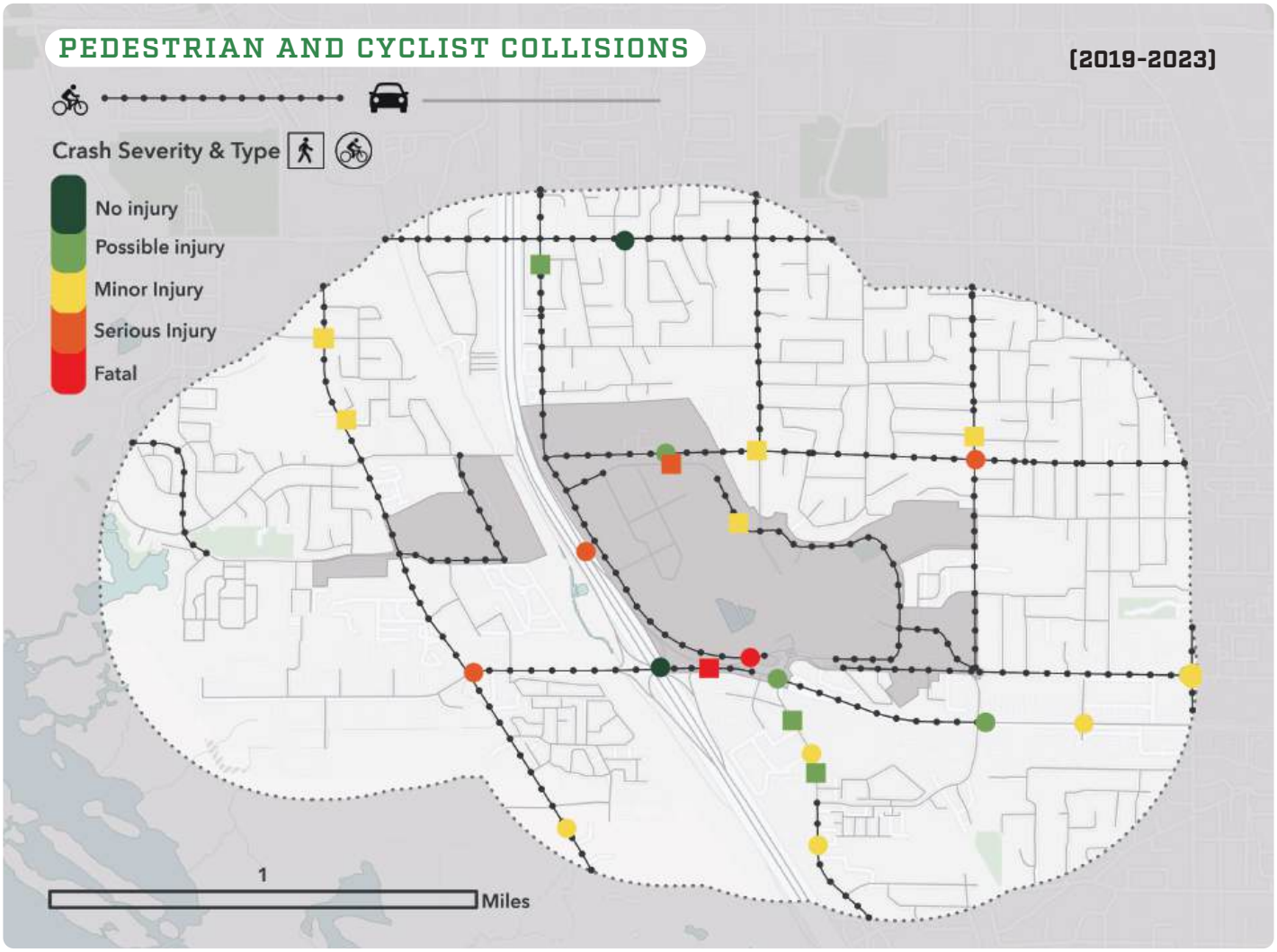
Pedestrian and Cyclist Collisions

- **COLLEGE DRIVE**
  A cyclist fatality occurred just west of the roundabout where traffic merges from University Parkway. This dangerous segment currently lacks any bike facilities.

- **UNIVERSITY PARKWAY**
  A pedestrian fatality occurred in this area east of the I-15 interchange, which has no sidewalks.

- **SANDHILL ROAD**
  Five reported collisions within a half-mile stretch including two cyclists and three pedestrians. While injuries were minor, the frequency of incidents signals a need for dedicated facilities, traffic calming, and wayfinding to safer facilities (underpasses).

- **800 SOUTH**
  Collisions involving both pedestrians and cyclists concentrated at intersections and parking lot entrances, indicating a need for improved crossings and traffic calming.



Public Transit Routes

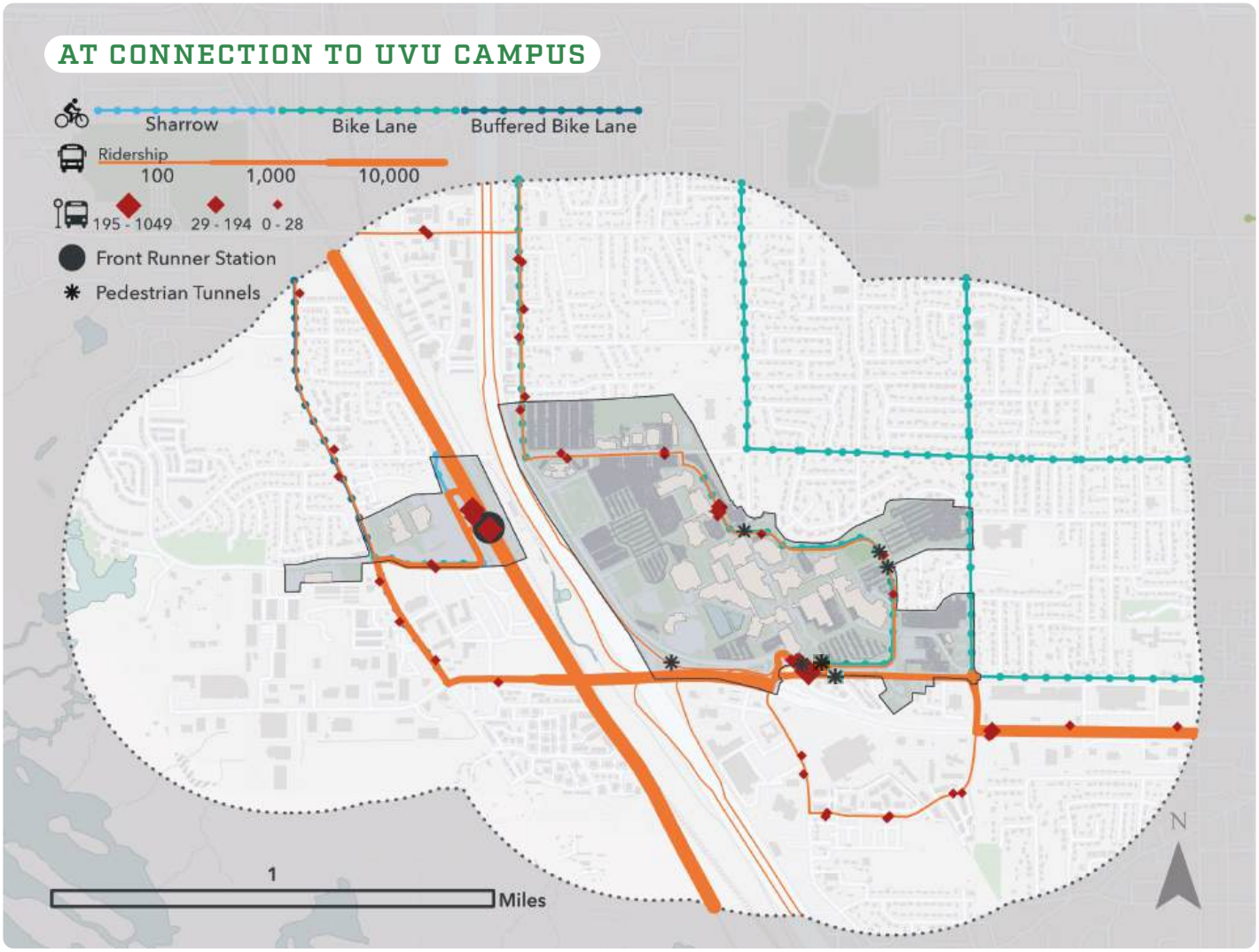
- **UTA SCHOOL PASS PROGRAM**
  The UTA School Pass Program provides free access to public transit for UVU students, faculty, staff, and their spouses and dependents.

- **FRONTRUNNER** provides regional transit access, stopping at Orem Central Station with a direct connection to UVU via the pedestrian bridge over I-15. Service runs every 30 minutes during peak hours and hourly during off-peak, with no Sunday service.

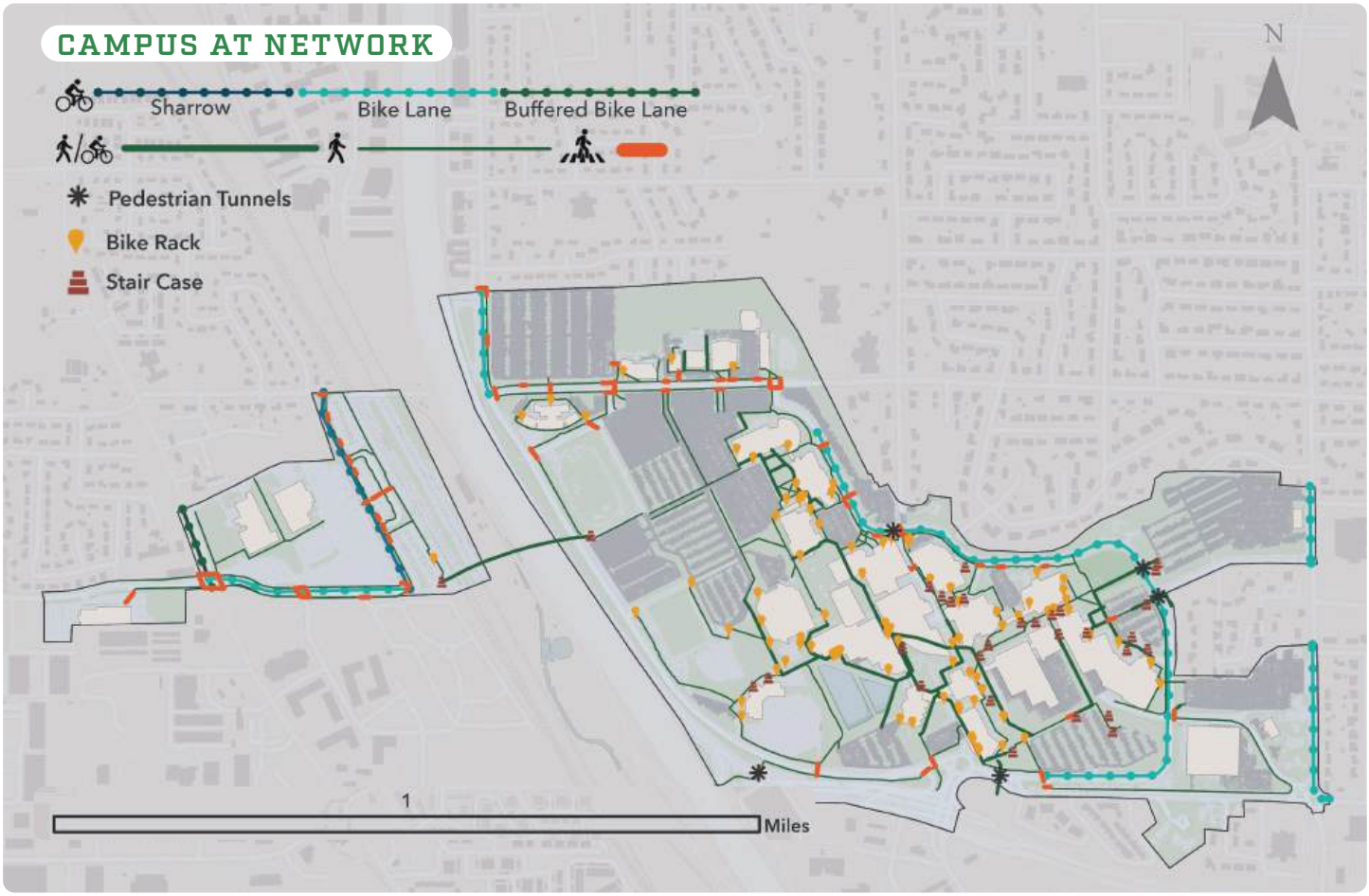
- **UVX (UTAH VALLEY EXPRESS)** provides bus rapid transit service between Orem and Provo with local stops at Orem Central Station and UVU Station. Service runs every 6-10 minutes during peak periods and 15-30 minutes at other times, and no Sunday service.

- **BUS ROUTES 831 & 862**
  Bus Routes 831 and 862 offer local all-day service with 30-minute frequencies, connecting UVU to destinations throughout Orem. These routes stop at several campus locations, including the Fulton Library, Institute, Gunther Building, UVU Station, and Orem Central Station.

- **BUS ROUTES 805-822**
  Bus Routes 805, 806, 807, and 822 provide limited peak-hour regional service to communities outside Orem. Each operates 4–6 trips per direction per day, running toward UVU in the morning and away from campus in the afternoon. Service frequency ranges from 30 to 60 minutes, and none of these routes operate on weekends.



Traveling On Campus



Source: UGRC Roads Centerline Data, Utah Building Footprints, NAIP Imagery (2024).

Once on campus, the quality of walking and biking routes shapes how people move through UVU.

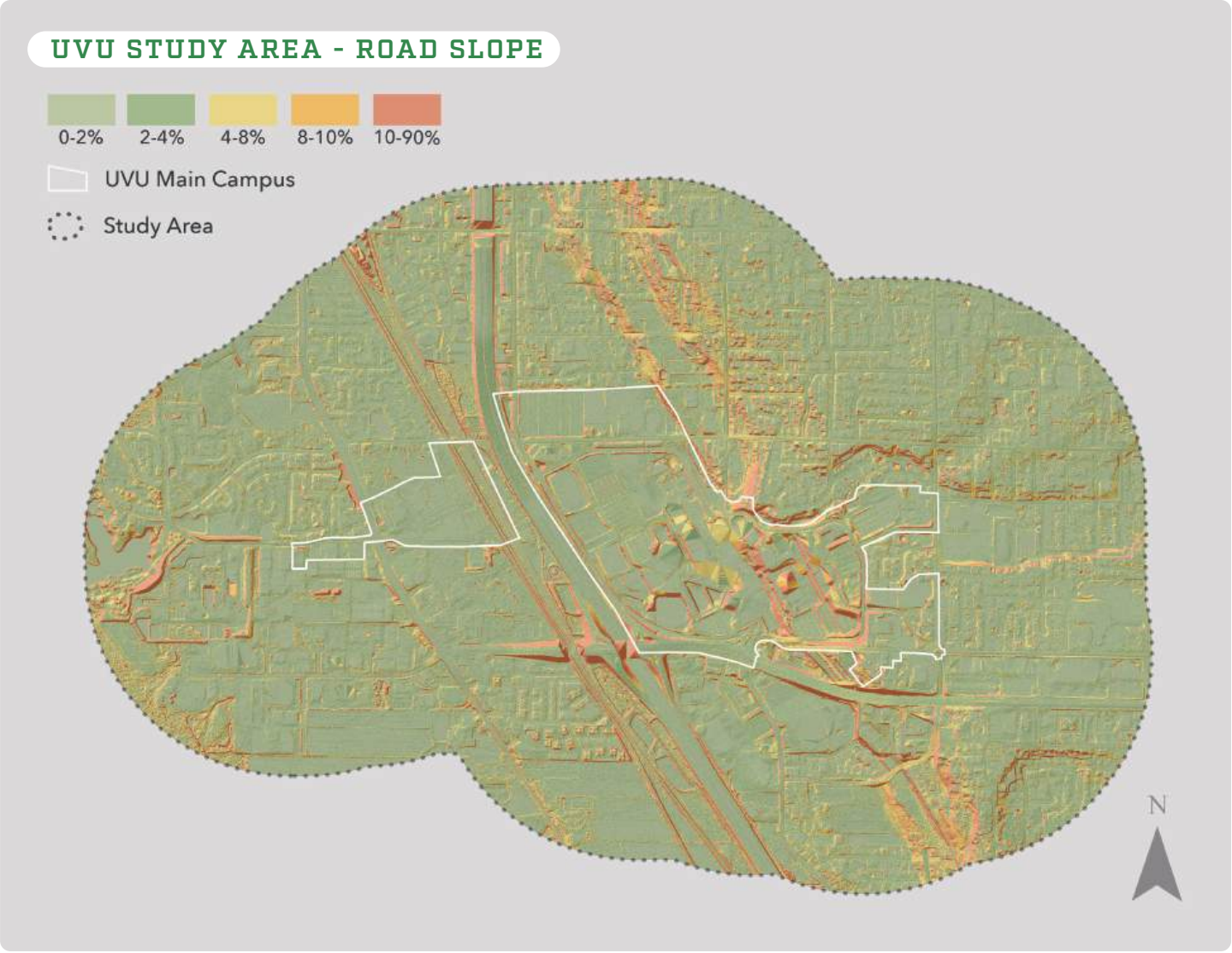
This section reviews on campus facilities including paths, crossings, bike parking, tunnels, stairs, slopes, and shade to find ways to improve comfort, access, and connectivity between destinations.

Campus AT Network

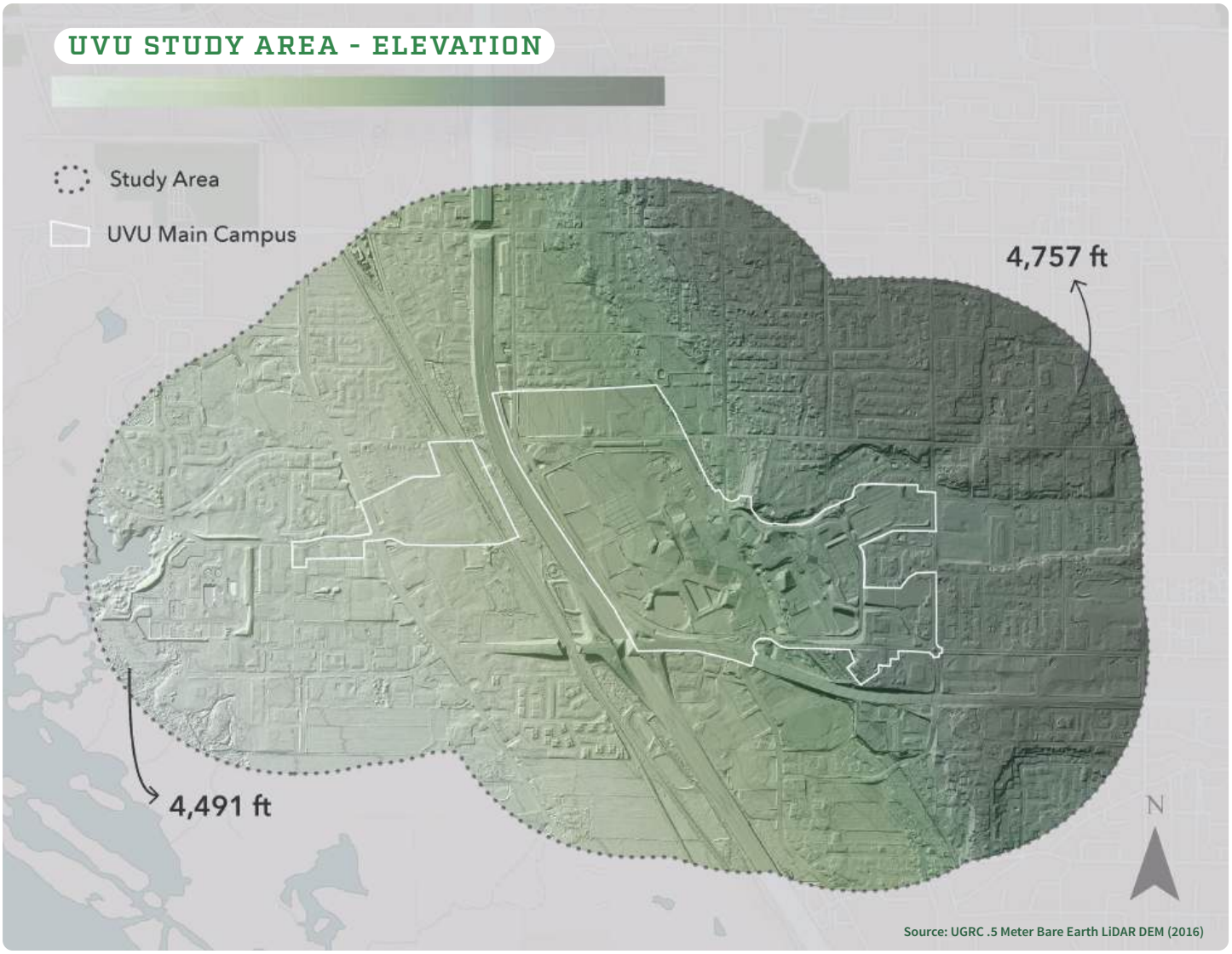
- **COMPACT BUILDING LAYOUT**
  Most campus buildings are clustered in the central and eastern areas, with interior connections that allow students to travel between buildings without going outside. While convenient for pedestrians, this layout creates physical barriers for people biking through campus.
- **INCONSISTENT MULTI-USE PATHS**
  Multi-use paths are not continuous and often terminate at parking lots, limiting their usefulness for cyclists and reducing overall connectivity.
- **BIKE LANE GAPS ON CIRCULATOR STREETS**
  While bike lanes exist on Campus Drive, they disappear near 800 South and the Sandhill Road roundabout. College Drive lacks bike lanes entirely. These gaps undermine cyclist safety and discourage active transportation.
- **STAIR BARRIERS**
  Stairs, especially on the east side of campus, pose a significant barrier to bike travel and present accessibility challenges for people with mobility devices.
- **BIKE PARKING**
  Bike racks are located throughout campus, including covered parking in the parking garage. However, increased visibility and signage are needed to ensure students know where secure bike parking is available.
- **BRIDGE AND UNDERPASSES** The I-15 bridge and underpasses at Campus Drive and University Parkway offer key connections across high-speed corridors but could benefit from improvements to increase comfort, safety, and aesthetic appeal.

Slope

- **GENTLE OVERALL GRADE**
  The study area spans an elevation change of 266 feet over approximately two miles, resulting in an average grade of 2.5%, which is generally manageable for walking and biking.
- **STEEP EASTERN SLOPES**
  The eastern side of campus features much steeper terrain, where stairs are often the only way to traverse grade changes. These steep areas create significant barriers for cyclists and individuals with mobility impairments.



Source: UGRC .5 Meter Bare Earth LiDAR DEM (2016)


UVU STUDY AREA - ELEVATION
Study Area
UVU Main Campus
4,757 ft
4,491 ft
N
Source: UGRC .5 Meter Bare Earth LiDAR DEM (2016)

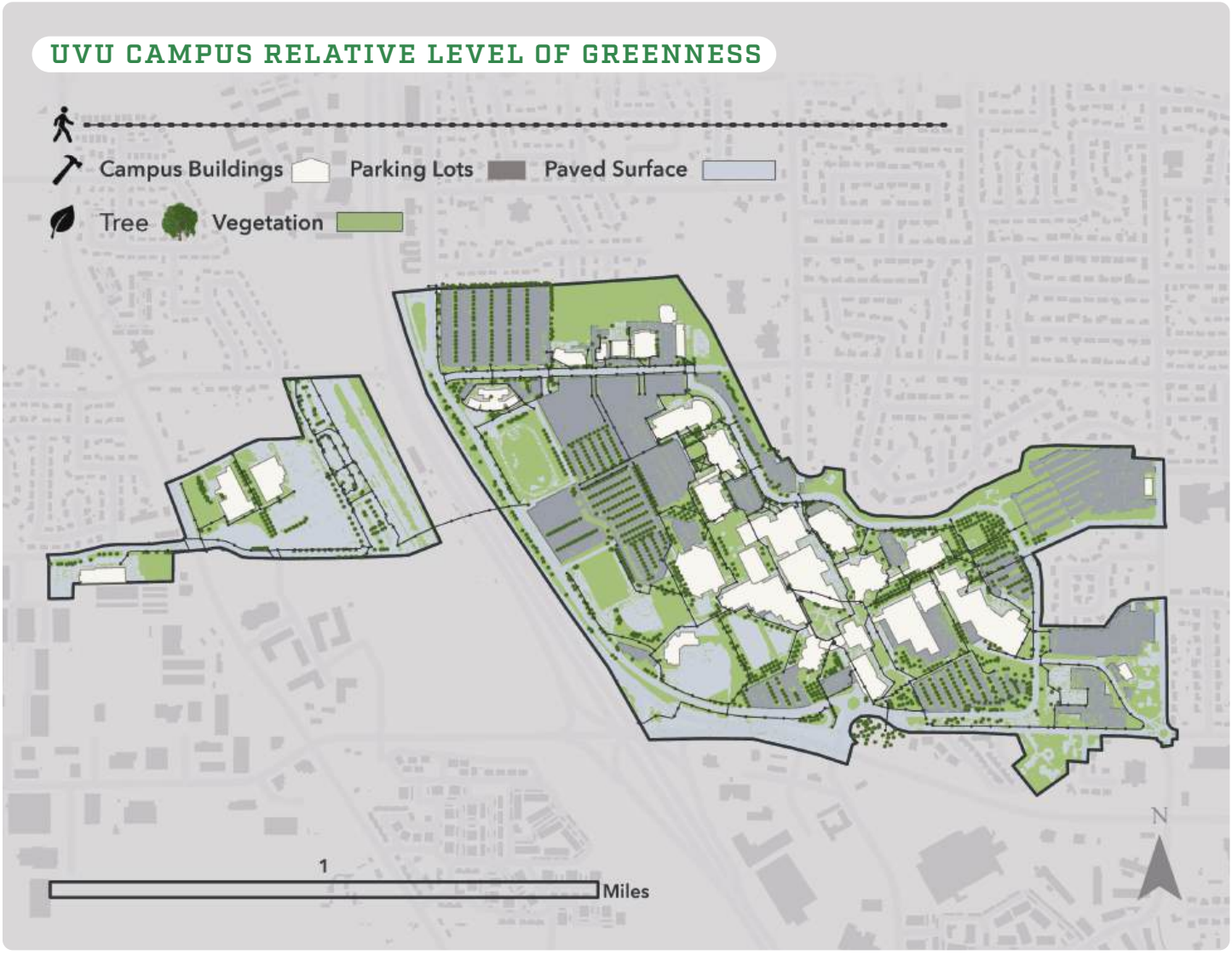




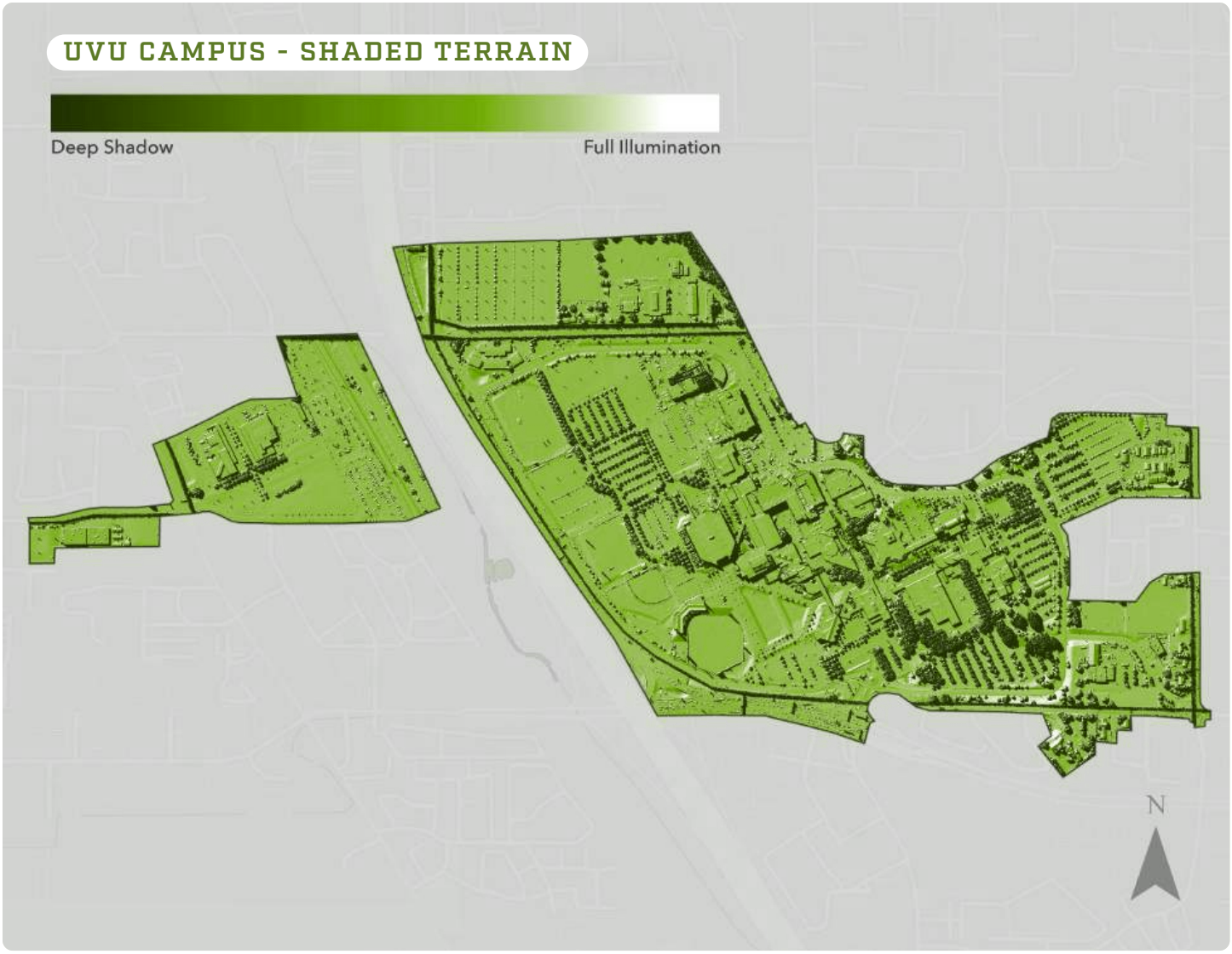


Trees, Vegetation, and Shade

- **COMFORT AND VISUAL INTEREST**
  Trees and vegetation enhance comfort by providing shade and visual variety, helping to encourage more walking and biking.
- **LACK OF SHADE IN PARKING AREAS**
  Large parking lots often lack adequate trees and vegetation, especially those south of 800 South and west of 400 West. These areas can become hot and uncomfortable for people walking or biking. Prioritize adding trees near AT routes within these lots.
- **LIMITED PLANT DIVERSITY**
  Much of the campus landscaping relies on a narrow selection of grasses and trees. Increasing plant diversity can enhance visual interest and improve the walking and biking experience.



Source: NAIP Imagery (2024), UGRC Building Footprints, Orem City Aerial Imagery (2021)



Source: UGRC .5 Meter Bare Earth LiDAR DEM (2016)







Current and Future Land Use

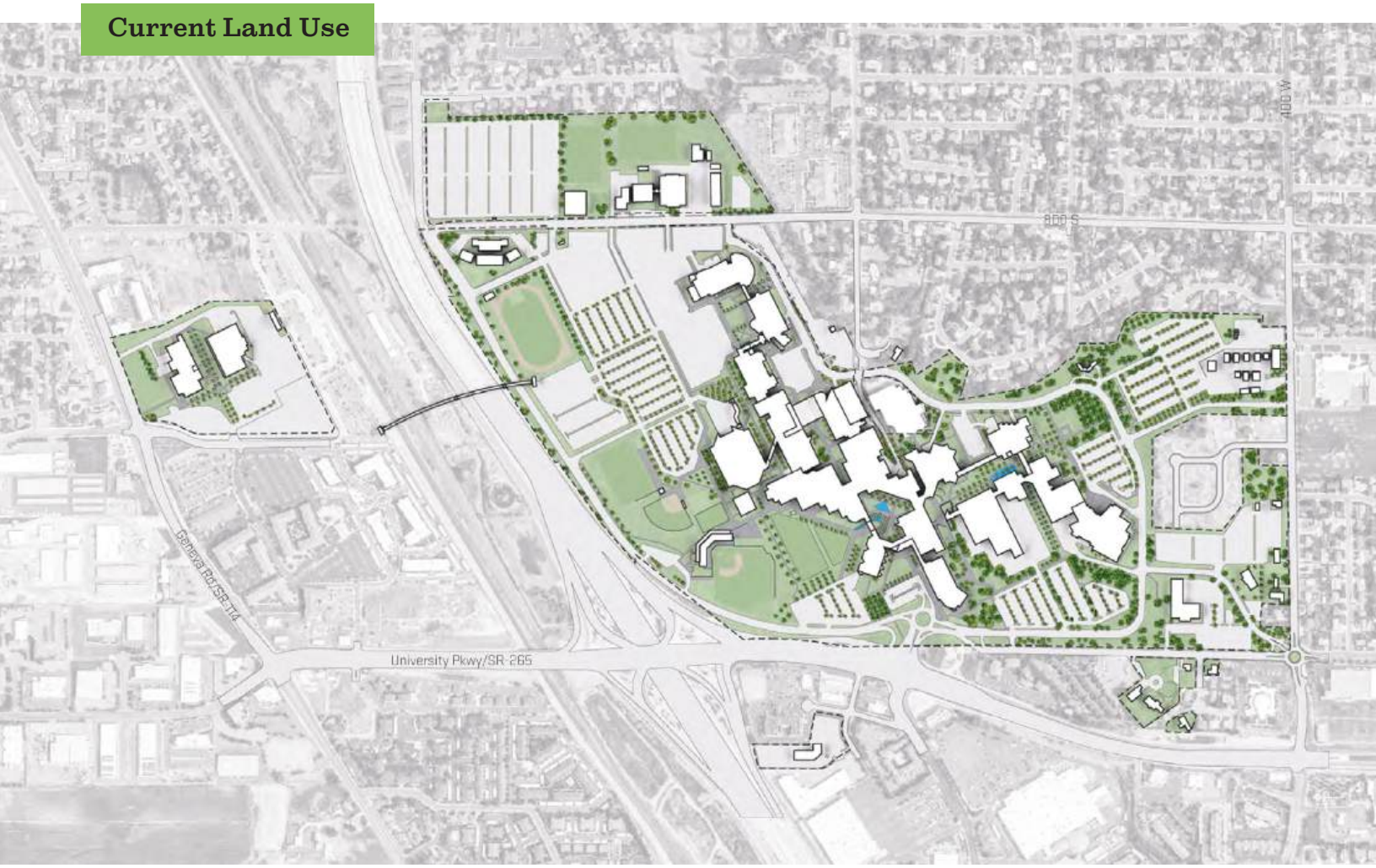
Land use strategies at UVU are guided by the UVU Facilities Master Plan (2021 Update), which outlines a long-term framework for campus development. As a landlocked campus adjacent to I-15, the Orem FrontRunner station, and regional bus lines, UVU is focusing on maximizing space through infill, vertical expansion, and improved multimodal access.

- **COMPACT CAMPUS FOOTPRINT**
  The main campus spans approximately 265 acres and is bordered by established neighborhoods, making infill and densification critical for future growth.

- **PRIMARY GROWTH STRATEGIES:**
  - **Strategy A:** Maximize campus capacity through infill development and vertical expansion.
  - **Strategy B:** Relocate non-academic facilities and services off the Main Campus.
  - **Strategy C:** Improve vehicular, transit, and pedestrian circulation systems.

- **NEW ACADEMIC SPINE**
  Two new academic buildings were originally planned along a west-side axis extending from the Classroom and New McKay Education buildings, replacing existing parking lots to form a western academic corridor. However, west-side expansion is likely paused indefinitely due to shifting legislative funding priorities, market conditions, and demographic trends.

Current Land Use

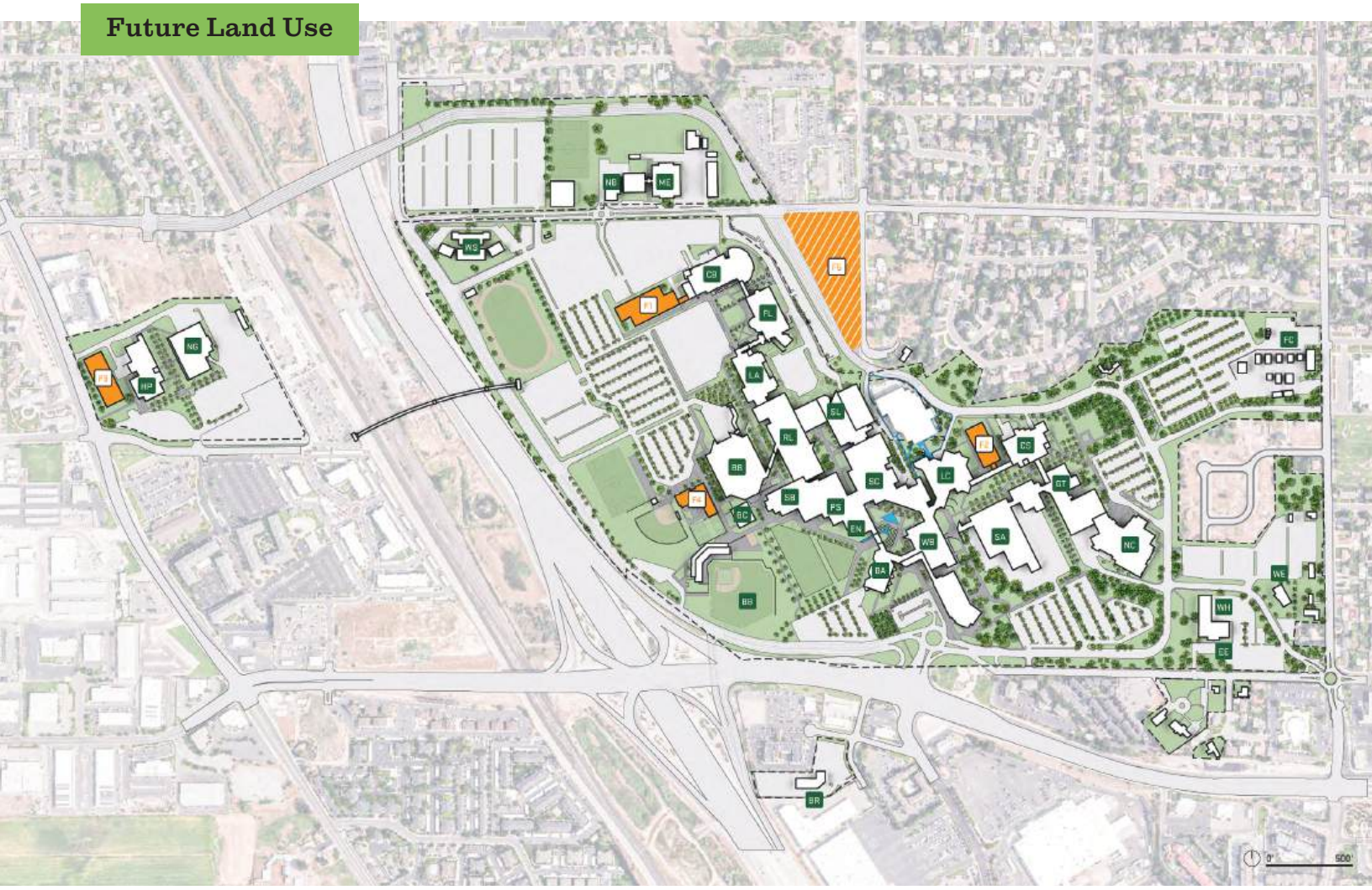


Current Land Use, UVU Facilities Master Plan (2021 Update)

- **EASTERN CAMPUS REDEVELOPMENT**
  The single-family homes along 400 West are designated for redevelopment into academic buildings, creating a new eastern academic cluster and enhancing the campus edge.

- **CENTRAL POND REDEVELOPMENT**
  The larger central pond area may be reimagined as a prominent, multifunctional space to serve as a focal point within campus.

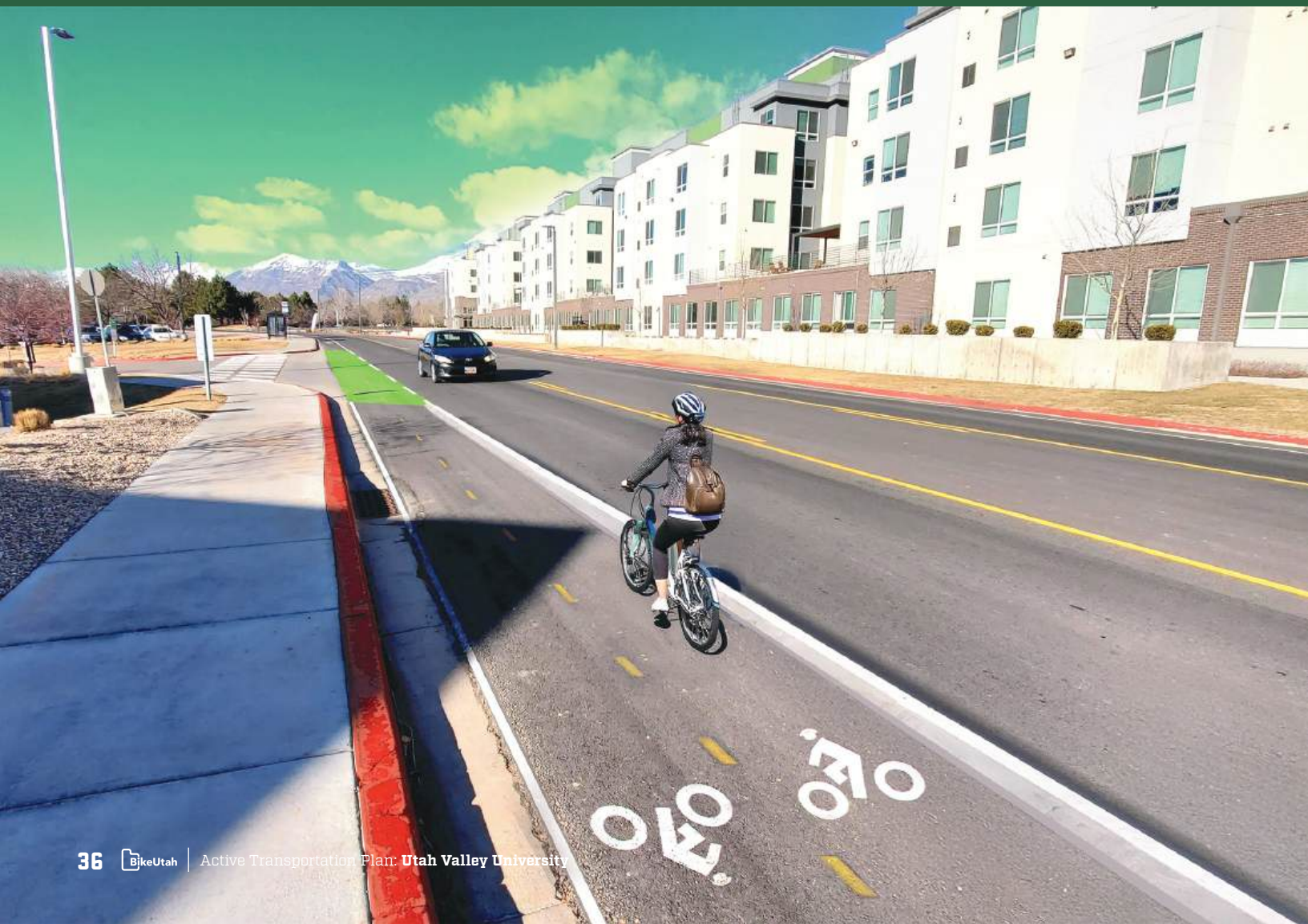
Future Land Use



Future Land Use, UVU Facilities Master Plan (2021 Update)

CHAPTER

04 Facility Recommendations



Summary

This plan provides comprehensive recommendations to make active transportation on campus safer, more convenient, and more attractive for students, faculty, staff, and visitors. These recommendations include the UVU Bike Loop, new and improved multi-use paths, bike parking hubs and racks, wayfinding signs, comfort improvements, and supporting amenities.

In total, these improvements are estimated to cost around $3.628 million. **This is less than 1% of UVU's annual budget with the potential to provide significant benefits to safety, accessibility, and campus life.**

The map and table below provide a summary of all recommended improvements, with additional detail provided in the following sections.



Summary of Recommendations

Facility Type	Length/#	Cost Estimate
UVU Bike Loop (two-way protected bike lane)	2.57 miles	$2.171M
Multi-Use Paths	1.23 miles	$733k
Engineering and Design for Bike Loop and Multi-Use Paths (+10%)	n/a	$290k
Bike Parking Hubs	4	n/a
Bike Racks	80	$19k
Wayfinding Signs	33	$20k
Comfort Improvements	n/a	$395k*
	Total:	**$3.628M**

*Comfort improvement costs are shown here as a midpoint cost estimate within a range of $242,340 - $546,850, described more fully at the end of this chapter.

UVU Bike Loop



Install 29 directional signs along the UVU Bike Loop.

UVU Bike Loop Encircles Campus

The UVU Bike Loop is a two-way protected bike lane encircling campus via Campus Drive, College Drive, and 800 South. The loop provides a low-stress, high-visibility route that connects key destinations and will encourage more people to bike.

On the southern end, the UVU Bike Loop briefly becomes a multi-use path that cuts through campus, bypassing the Sandhill Road roundabout to maintain safety and comfort. This multi-use path segment is described with the other campus multi-use paths in the following section.

Design

Two-way protected bike lanes, sometimes called cycle tracks, are physically separated bike lanes that allow travel in both directions on one side of the street. While this design can create additional complexity at intersections and driveways, it works especially well at UVU because most campus destinations are on one side of the road. This layout reduces unnecessary crossings, simplifies navigation, and creates a signature facility that reflects UVU's commitment to active transportation.

- 3-lane roads with 10-ft lane widths
- Two 6-ft bike lanes (two-way) on the campus side of the street
- At least 2-ft buffer separating bike lanes from vehicle traffic, with physical barrier (curb, flex post) where feasible
- Green paint markings at intersections and driveways



Two-way bike lane (unprotected) on 300 N in Salt Lake City.



Two-way protected bike lane in front of Northwestern University campus in Evanston, Illinois.

Benefits

- Improves connectivity and directness when destinations are concentrated on one side of the street
- Lower implementation cost than building one-way protected bike lanes
- Uses less road space compared to one-way protected bike lanes
- Often perceived as more attractive, comfortable, and intuitive for riders
- Offers a trail-like experience when connected to multi-use paths

Cost

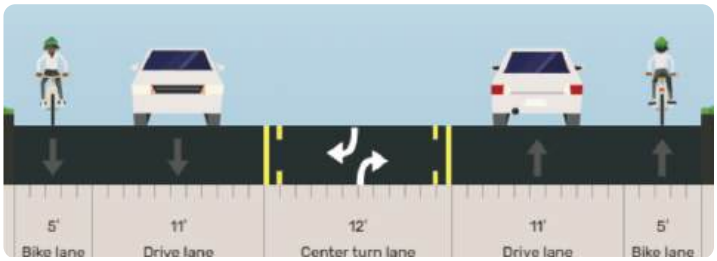
Segment Location	Length	Conflict Points	*Cost Estimate
Campus Drive	1.30 miles	11 intersections 3 bus stops 1 mid-block crossing	$1.098M
College Drive	0.82 miles	4 intersections	$0.693M
800 South	0.45 miles	5 intersections 2 bus stops 1 mid-block crossing	$0.380M
Off-street multi-use paths	Described on page 58		
Total:	**2.57 miles**	**20 intersections 5 bus stops 2 mid-block crossings**	**$2.171M**

*Estimated construction cost for a two-way protected bike lane is $160 per linear foot, which includes street restriping, green paint at crossings, curbs/flex posts, and signage. Does not include extra costs for conflict points.

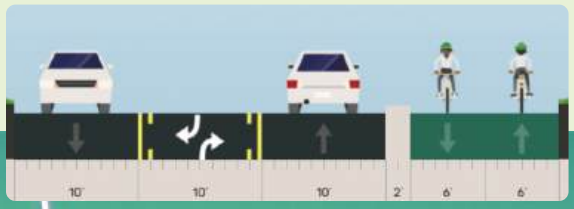
Campus Drive (east side of campus)

EXISTING CONFIGURATION





PROPOSED CONFIGURATION WITH UVU BIKE LOOP

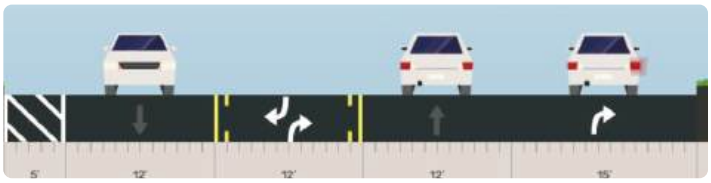




College Drive (west side of campus)

EXISTING CONFIGURATION





PROPOSED CONFIGURATION WITH UVU BIKE LOOP

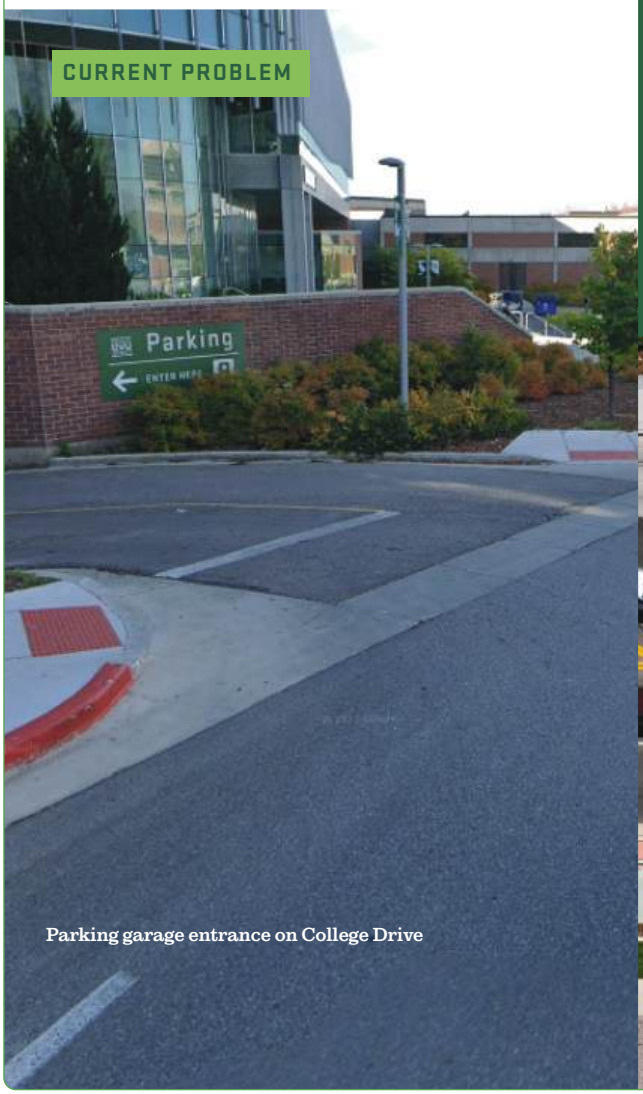




Conflict Points

Intersections and Driveways

Intersections and driveways require careful design to ensure safety and clarity for all road users. Because cyclists are traveling in both directions on one side of the street, turning drivers may not expect bikes approaching from the opposite direction.



Parking garage entrance on College Drive

STRATEGIES TO REDUCE THESE CONFLICTS:

- **Use high-visibility green paint** along the bike lane within the intersection
- **Keep corner radii tight** to slow turning vehicles. Corner islands can be used to further slow vehicle traffic
- **Remove parking** and other obstacles near corners to improve sight lines
- **Provide leading pedestrian intervals** or dedicated bike signal phases where feasible (at traffic lights)
- **Install signs** to alert drivers of two-way bike traffic and turning conflicts
- **Use reflective poles** so cycle tracks are still delineated under snow cover



Two-way protected bike lane on 300 W in Salt Lake City

Bus stops

Bus stops located along two-way protected bike lanes also require special treatment to minimize conflicts. Design should ensure cyclists yield to passengers who may need to cross the bike lane.

CURRENT PROBLEM



Fulton Library bus stop on College Drive

STRATEGIES TO REDUCE THESE CONFLICTS:

Include a designated pedestrian crossing zone across the bike lane with clear striping and signage

- **Alter the bike lane pavement** or elevation to signal to cyclists that pedestrians may be present
- **Install "yield to pedestrians" signs** near the bus stop
- **Provide bus stop islands** where space allows, placing the bus stop on an island between the bike lane and vehicle lane

CONFLICT SOLUTION



Bus stop island on G Street SW in Washington DC (MDOT)



Bus stop island on 200 S in Salt Lake City



Bus stop island on NE Weidler in Portland, Oregon (BikePortland)

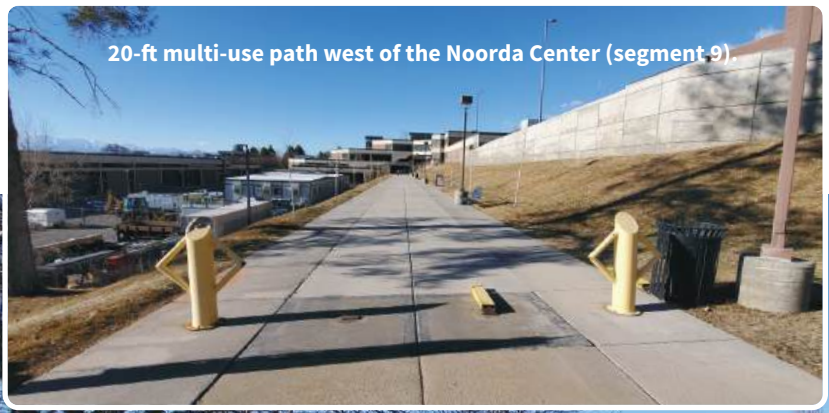
Multi-Use Paths

Multi-use paths are shared facilities that accommodate two-way pedestrian and cyclist traffic. For this plan, existing multi-use paths are defined as any path at least 10 feet wide. This excludes narrower sidewalks that are not suitable for shared bicycle and pedestrian use.

While UVU has many existing multi-use paths, significant gaps within the network make it difficult to easily and comfortably navigate. This plan identifies specific routes to improve path continuity and provide clear, direct connections through campus.

MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **10 ft minimum width.** At least 12 ft preferred in high-traffic areas.
- **At least 2 ft buffer** from roads or parking lots, where applicable.
- **Landscaping and trees** along the path.
- **Wayfinding at intersections** and decision points.

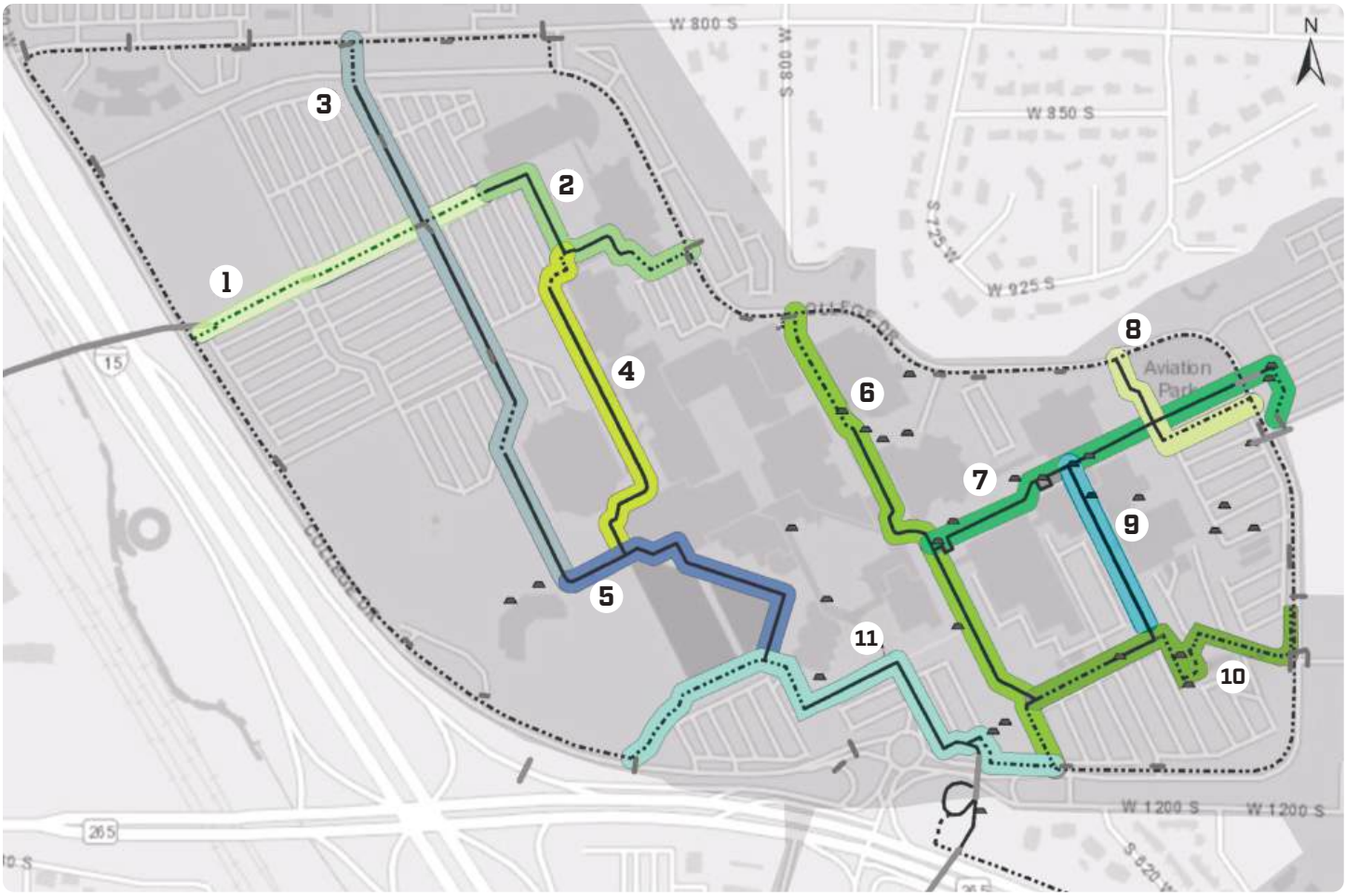


20-ft multi-use path west of the Noorda Center (segment 9).



10-ft multi-use path northeast of the UCCU Center (segment 4).

Multi-Use Path - Segment References



Multi-Use Path Key

1. I-15 pedestrian bridge to Clarke Building
2. Clarke Building to Campus Drive
3. 800 S to Ballpark
4. Fulton Library to Ballpark
5. Ballpark to Browning Administration
6. Parking Garage to Campus Drive (south end)
7. Woodbury Building to 960 S Street
8. Aviation park
9. Computer Science to Noorda Center
10. Keller Building to Wolverine Way
11. College Drive to Campus Drive (UVU Bike Loop Connector)

Multi-Use Paths Recommendations

#	Segment Location	Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
1	**I-15 pedestrian bridge to Clarke Building**	-*	0.08 miles	0.17 miles	2 crossings 1 curb cut	$162,856
2	**Clarke Building to Campus Drive**	0.19 miles	0.06 miles	-	3 curb cuts	$25,344
3	**800 S to Ballpark**	0.42 miles	0.10 miles	-	3 crossings 2 curb cuts 50 parking stops	$51,840
4	**Fulton Library to Ballpark**	0.27 miles	0.04 miles	-	-	$16,896
5	**Ballpark to Browning Administration**	0.26 miles	-	-	-	-
6	**Parking Garage to Campus Drive (south end)**	0.30 miles	0.17 miles	-	1 curb cut	$72,808
7	**Woodbury Building to 960 S Street**	0.33 miles	0.04 miles	-	4 staircases	$76,896
8	**Aviation park**	0.08 miles	-	0.08 miles	1 curb cut	$60,136
9	**Computer Science to Noorda Center**	0.18 miles	-	-	-	-
10	**Keller Building to Wolverine Way**	0.05 miles	0.23 miles	0.04 miles	1 staircase 2 curb cuts	$151,112
11	**College Drive to Campus Drive (UVU Bike Loop Connector)**	0.22 miles	0.15 miles	0.07 miles	-	$115,104
	Total:	**2.30 miles**	**0.87 miles**	**0.36 miles**	**5 crossings 6 staircases 10 curb cuts**	**$732,992**

*The current on-street pedestrian lane is not counted as an existing sidewalk or multi-use path.

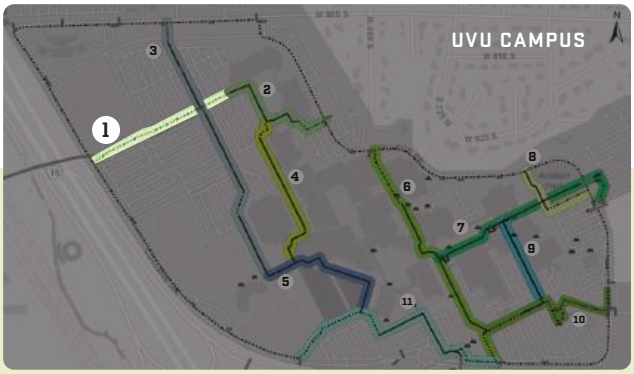
**Cost Estimates

New 12-ft multi-use path	$140 per linear foot
Sidewalk widening from 5 ft to 12 ft	$80 per linear foot
ADA ramp	$15,000 each
Crossing improvements (painted crosswalk, 2x crossing signs)	$1,200 each
Curb cut	$1,000 each
Parking stop	$80 each

Multi-Use Path Considerations

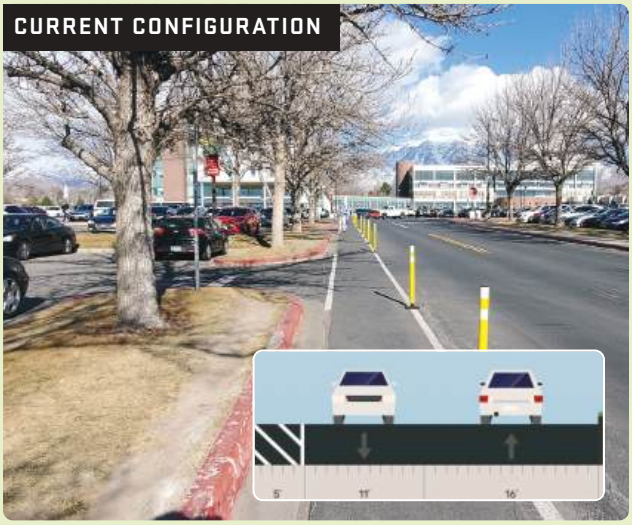
SEGMENT 1 I-15 pedestrian bridge to Clarke Building

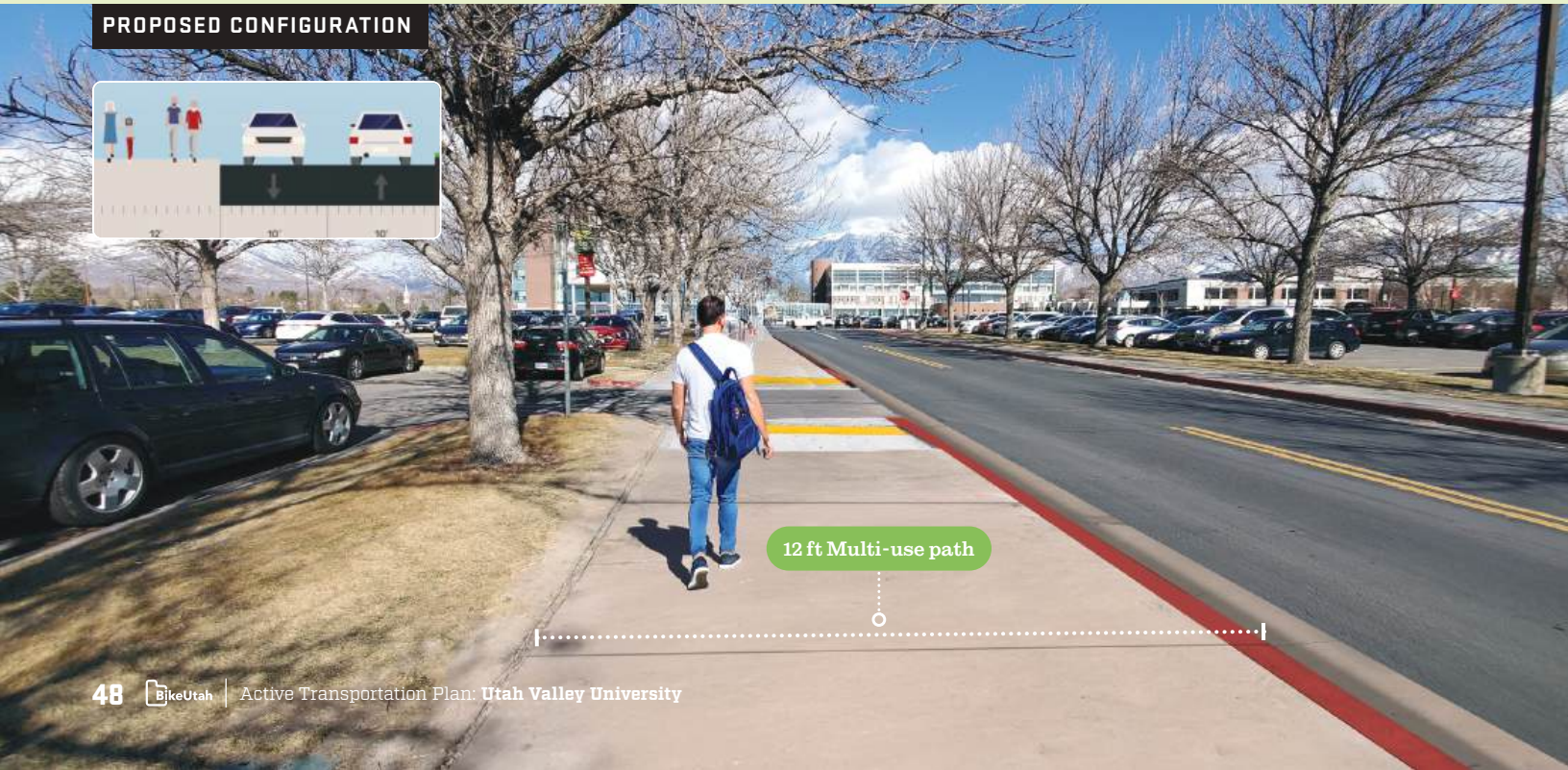
Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
-*	0.08 miles	0.17 miles	2 crossings 1 curb cut	$162,856



MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Reduce travel lane** widths to 10 ft
- **Curb protected** multi-use path
- **Build 9 parking lot driveways** and 2 crossings
- **Widen sidewalk** from 8 ft to 12 ft
- **Remove 4 parking spaces**
- **Install curb cut** connecting to the UVU Bike Loop

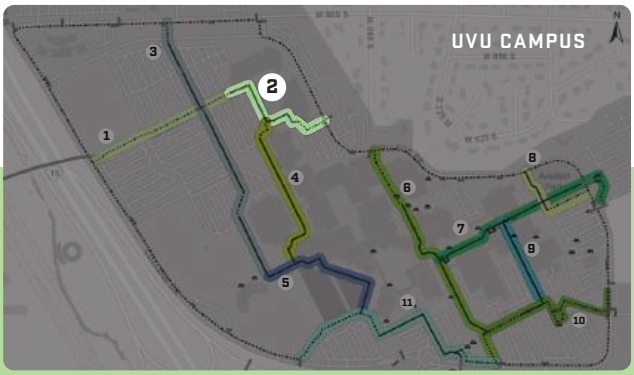




SEGMENT 2

Clark Building to Campus Drive

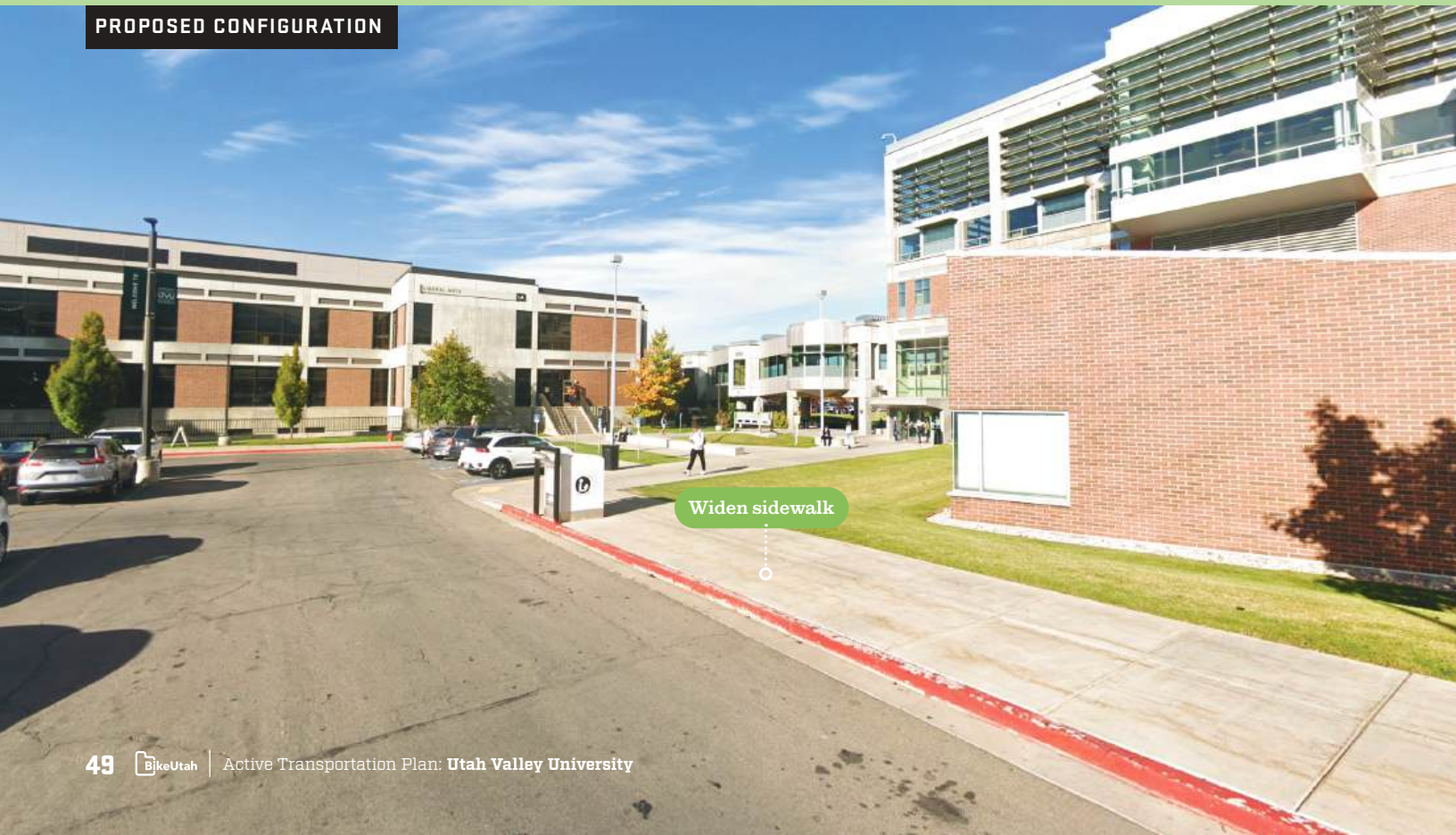
Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.19 miles	0.06 miles	-	3 curb cuts	$25,344



MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Widen path** from 10 ft to 12 ft to accommodate high traffic
- **Install 3 curb cuts** (1 on this path west of the library, 2 at the crossing north east of the library)

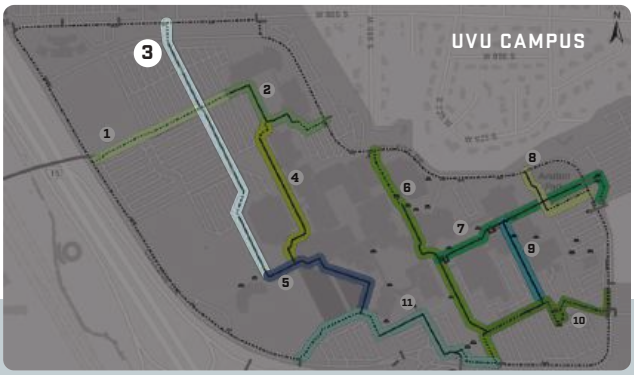




SEGMENT 3

800 S to Ballpark

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.42 miles	0.10 miles	-	3 crossings 2 curb cuts 50 parking stops	$51,840



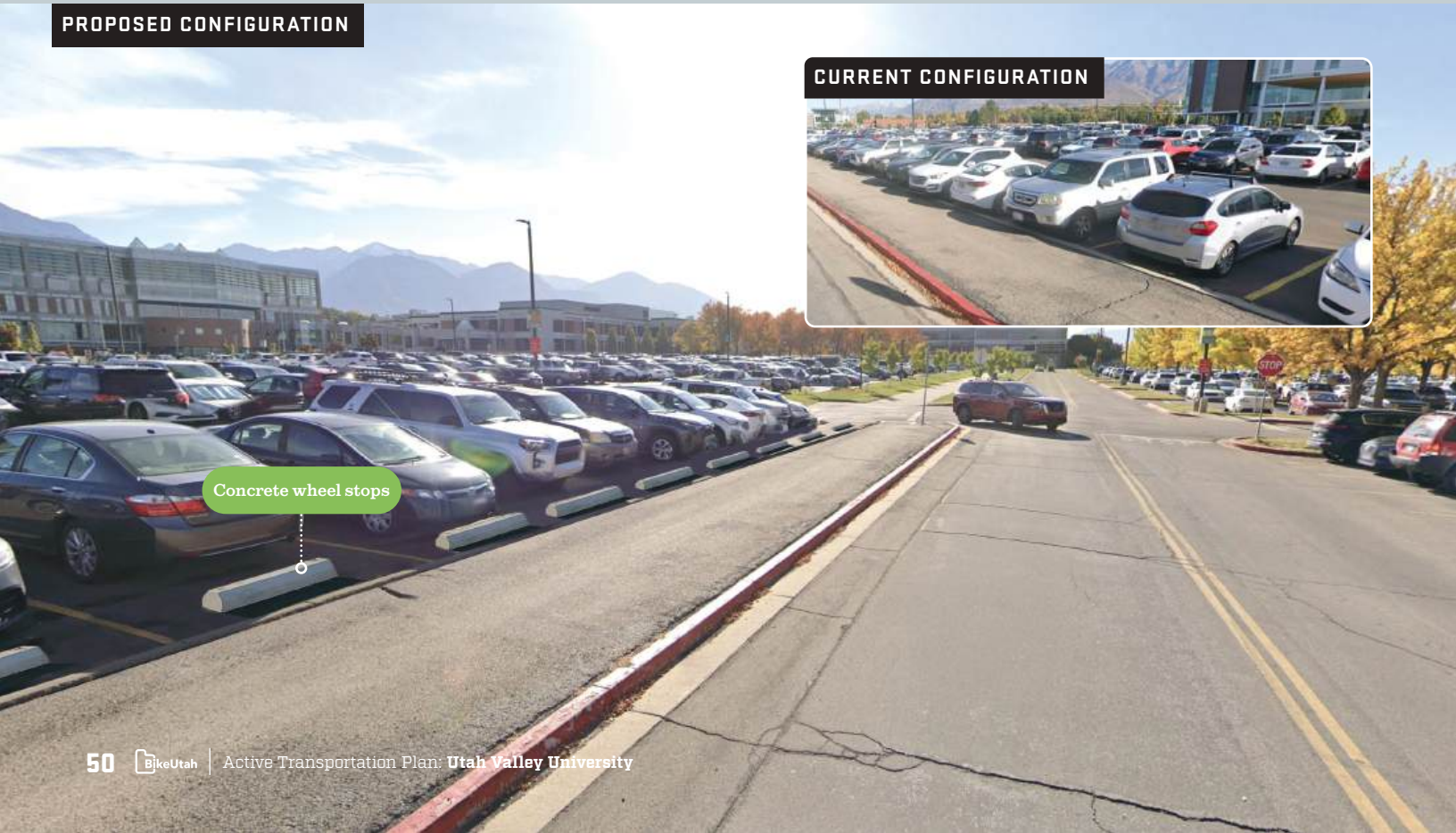
MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Widen sidewalk near 800 S** from 5 ft to 12 ft
- **Widen sidewalk near UCCU center** from 10 ft to 12 ft to address tight corners.
- **Install concrete wheel stops** in 50 parking spots to prevent cars from encroaching into the multi-use path.
- **Improve 2 crossings**

CURRENT CONFIGURATION



PROPOSED CONFIGURATION

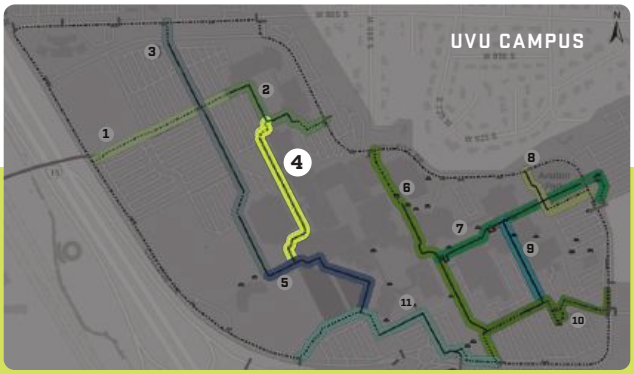


CURRENT CONFIGURATION

SEGMENT 4

Fulton Library to Ballpark

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.27 miles	0.04 miles	-	-	$16,896



MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Widen sidewalk** near Liberal Arts building from 10 ft to 12 ft to address tight corners. (use extra grass space)

PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



SEGMENT 5

Ballpark to Browning Administration

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.26 miles	-	-	-	-



THIS MULTI-USE PATH SEGMENT ALREADY EXISTS. NO IMPROVEMENTS NEEDED.





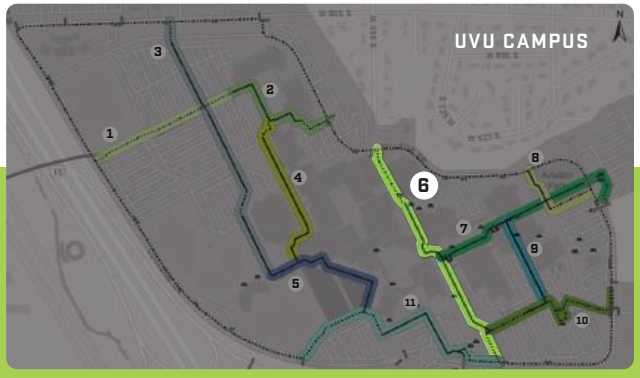




SEGMENT 6

Parking Garage to Campus Drive (south end)

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.30 miles	0.17 miles	-	1 curb cut	$72,808



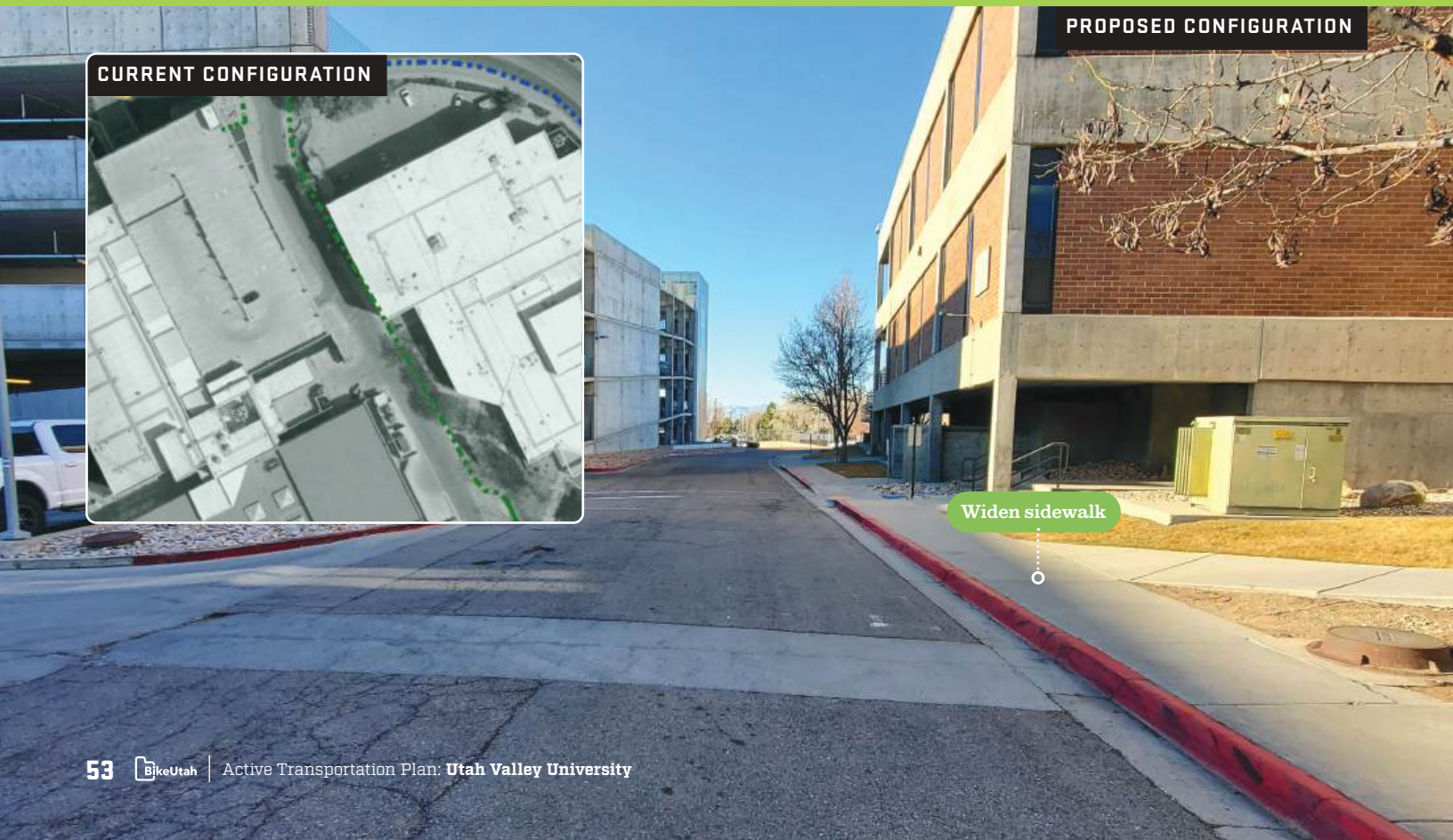
MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Widen sidewalk** west of the Institute from 5 ft to 12 ft
- **1 curb cut** southwest of the Institute

PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



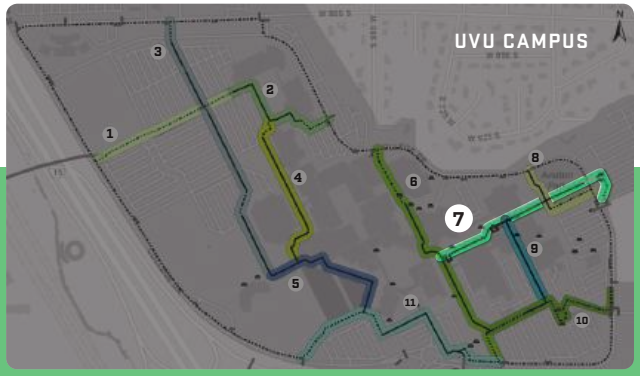




SEGMENT 7

Woodbury Building to 960 S Street

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.33 miles	0.04 miles	-	4 staircases	$76,896



MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Address 4 staircases** by installing bike ramp channels or accessible switchback ramps

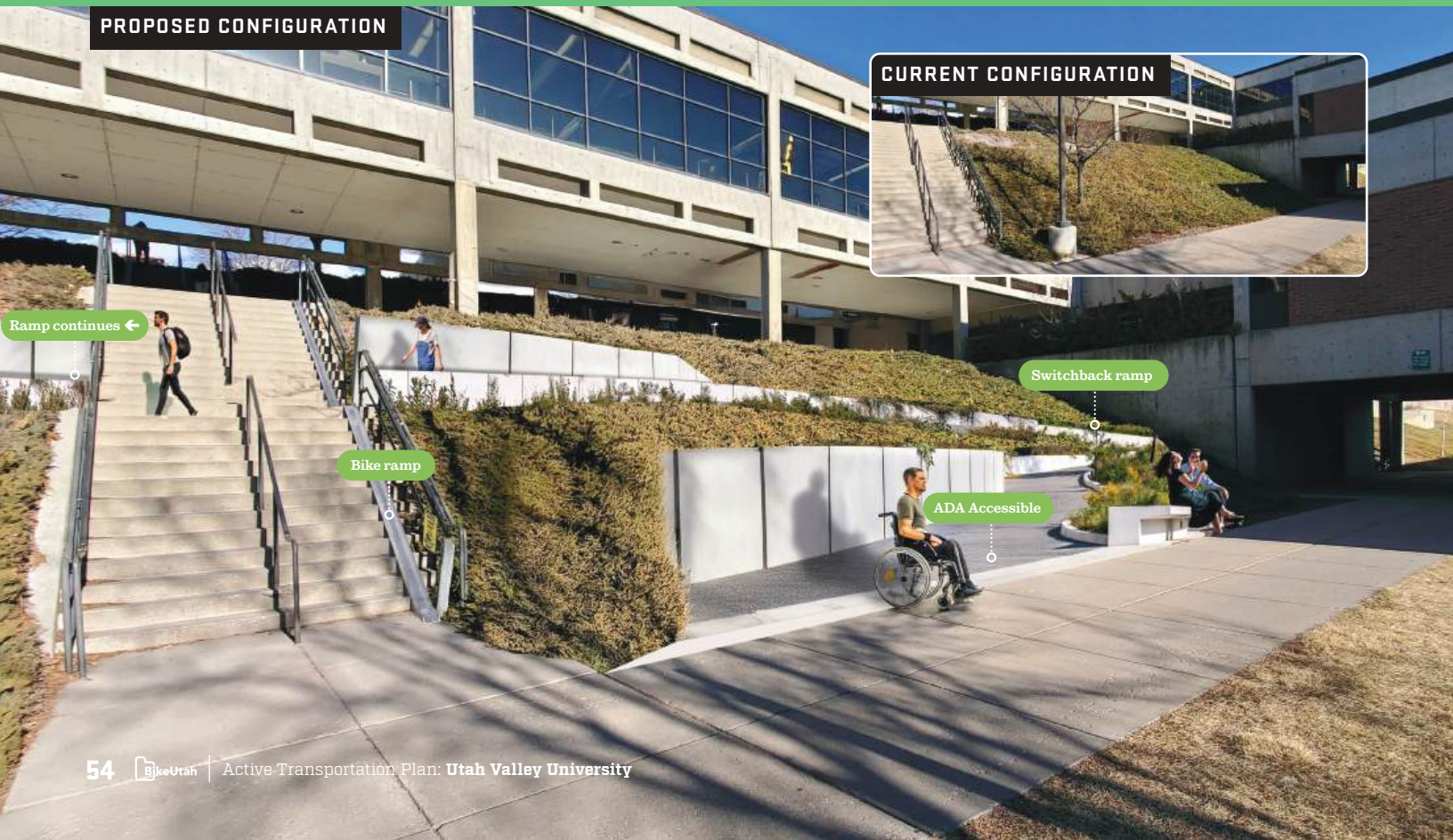
CURRENT CONFIGURATION



CURRENT CONFIGURATION



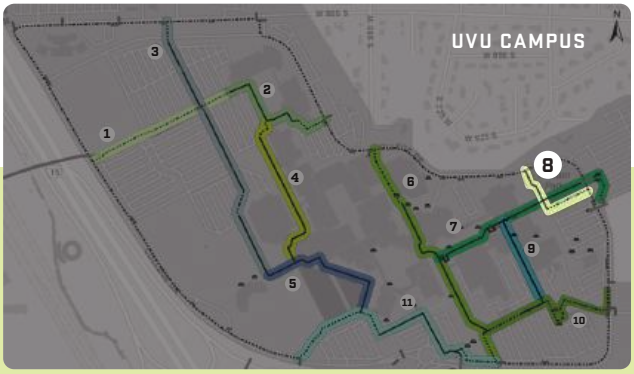
PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



CURRENT CONFIGURATION

SEGMENT 8

Aviation park



Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.08 miles	-	0.08 miles	1 curb cut	$60,136

MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Install new 12-ft multi-use path** between the trees on the south edge of aviation park. This connects to the UVU Bike Loop.
- **Install 2 curb cuts** connecting to the UVU Bike Loop.

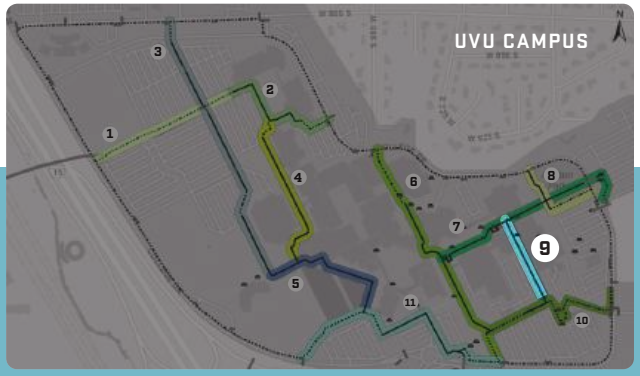




SEGMENT 9

Computer Science to Noorda Center

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.18 miles	-	-	-	-



THIS MULTI-USE PATH SEGMENT ALREADY EXISTS. NO IMPROVEMENTS NEEDED.



SEGMENT 10 Keller Building to Wolverine Way



Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.05 miles	0.23 miles	0.04 miles	1 staircase 2 curb cuts	$151,112

MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

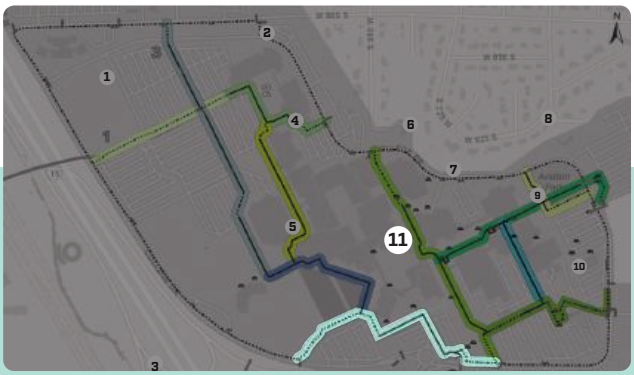
- **Widen sidewalk east of the Keller Building** from 5 ft to 12 ft
- **Widen sidewalk south of the Noorda building** from 5 ft to 12 ft
- **New 12 ft multi use path** slopes down





SEGMENT 11 College Drive to Campus Drive (UVU Bike Loop Connector)

Length (existing)	Length (sidewalk widening)	Length (new)	Conflict Points	Cost**
0.22 miles	0.15 miles	.07 miles	-	$115,104



MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Two-way bike lane** merges into two-way multi-use path
- **Sidewalk widened** from 5 ft to 12 ft
- **Multi-use path** slopes down
- **Sidewalk widened** from 4 ft to 12 ft
- **Replace small portion of the parking lot** with multi-use path

PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



PROPOSED CONFIGURATION



Conflict Points

Crossings

Crossing at roads or driveways create conflict between vehicles, pedestrians, and cyclists. These conflict points are found along **segments 1 and 3** near the central parking lots.





MULTI-USE PATHS RECOMMENDATIONS

- Install **high-visibility crosswalk markings** and signs.
- Provide **raised crossings and daylighting** where applicable.


RAISED CROSSWALK



CENTERLINE CROSSWALK SIGN


CROSSWALK DAYLIGHTING

Staircases

Staircases are a major barrier for cyclists and those with mobility limitations. Segment 7 includes 4 steep staircases, while Segments 9, 10, and 11 each include one staircase that interrupts path continuity.

STAIRCASES RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Install accessible switchback ramps** where space allows.
- **Install bike ramp channels** along stair edges in constrained location.


ADA SWITCHBACK RAMP


BIKE RAMP CHANNEL

Bike Racks

Bike parking is an important part of a complete active transportation system. Convenient, visible, and secure bike racks support and encourage biking to campus.

UVU provides a substantial number of bike racks throughout campus, although the rack style is not standardized. During this planning process, students noted that many bike parking areas are difficult to find, particularly the racks within the parking garage. Standardized design and improved wayfinding can help ensure bike racks are easy to use and access.

Best Practices

- **SHORT-TERM PARKING**
  Unsheltered, unenclosed bike racks with an intended parking duration up to two hours. The majority of public bike racks are considered short-term parking.

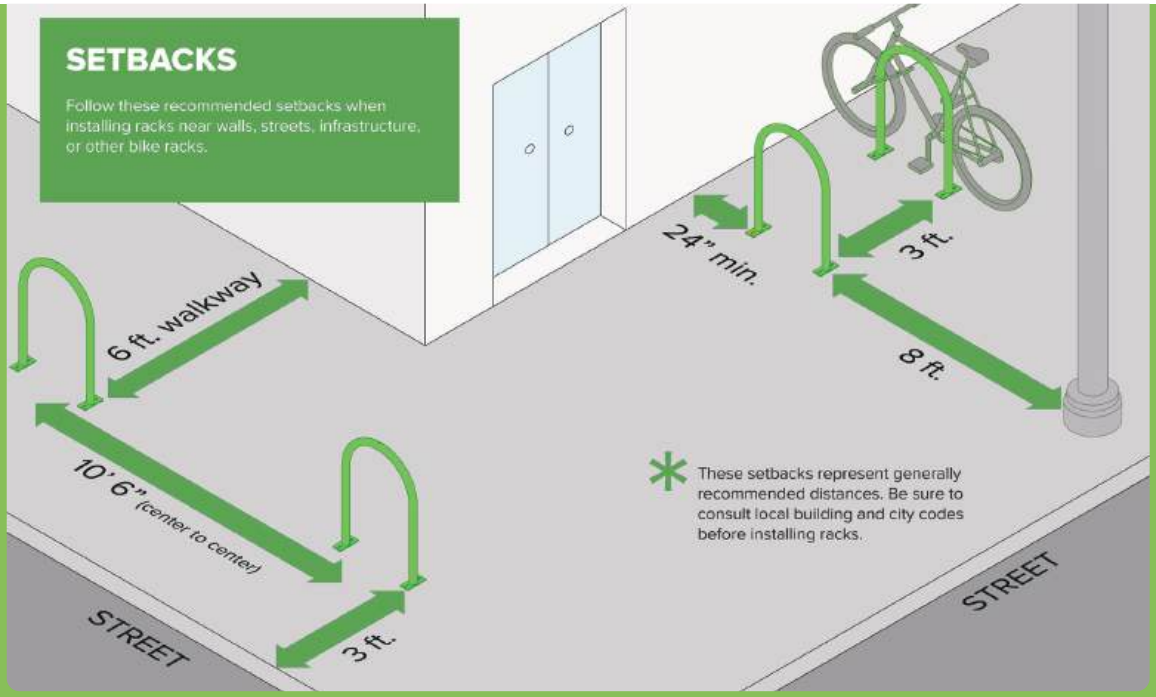
- **LONG-TERM PARKING**
  Provides added protection with an enclosure (shelters, bike rooms, lockers) or active surveillance (gate, bike valet, security cameras). Ideal for residential buildings and large, central parking areas.

- **PLACEMENT**
  Racks should be installed in open, accessible areas near building entrances, popular amenities, or vehicle parking, where foot traffic and visibility provide an added sense of security and convenience. Thoughtful placement increases the likelihood that the racks will be used and ensures they actually serve their intended purpose.

- **CLEARANCE**
  Racks should be placed at least 2 feet (24 inches) from walls or building edges, allowing enough room for bicycles to be maneuvered and secured. A minimum of 3 feet of clearance should be maintained between racks and nearby obstructions, such as light poles or other infrastructure, while at least 6 feet of unobstructed walkway should be preserved to support pedestrian movement. The recommended spacing between racks is 10 feet, 6 inches from center to center, providing adequate space for bicycles on either side. Additionally, racks should be positioned at least 8 feet from fixed objects such as poles and at least 3 feet from the curb or street edge.

These guidelines represent general best practices, though final placement should comply with local building and city codes, and may vary slightly depending on site-specific conditions or constraints.

https://www.dero.com/bike-parking-guide.pdf

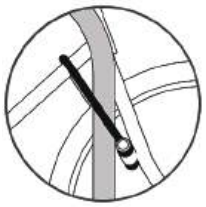


Design

When selecting rack designs, be sure that racks provide at least two points of contact with the frame and allow users to easily secure the frame and one wheel with a U-lock. Standard U-racks or similar models are the simplest and cheapest option, about $160 per rack. More artistic rack designs are available but cost significantly more and can compromise functionality.



TWO POINT CONTACT



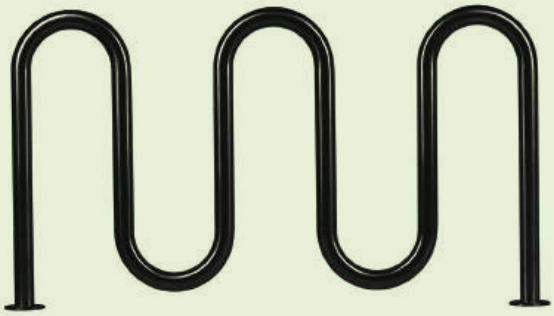
LOCK WHEEL & FRAME

Bike Racks Type and Costs



U-Rack

Cost	# Existing	Note
$160	51	Simple, cost-effective rack that allows 2 bikes to be parked securely. Provides two points of contact and is compatible with U-locks. **Recommended standard.**



Wave Rack

Cost	# Existing	Note
5 Bikes: $439 **7 Bikes:** $569 **9 bikes:** $709 **11 bikes:** $839	**7 bikes:** 7 **9 Bikes:** 6 **11 Bikes:** 10	Curved design that allows 4-12 bikes to be parked, depending on length. **Does not provide two points of contact, and can be confusing for users.**



Lightning Rack

Cost	# Existing	Note
$645	17	Angled design that allows 2 bikes to be parked. Compatible with U-locks, but does not provide two points of contact and is expensive.

NOT RECOMMENDED



Front Wheel Rack

Cost	# Existing	Note
4 Bikes: $359 **8 bikes:** $429 **9 bikes:** $679	**22**	Supports only the front wheel, often bending spokes. **Not compatible with U-locks. Not recommended.**



Covered Parking

Cost	# Existing	Note
$2,329-$18,969	**Wave (7 Bike):** 3* **Wave (11 Bike):** 1* **Front Wheel:** 7* **U-Rack:** 30* *double counted within categories above.	Provides shelter—typically a roof or canopy—to protect parked bicycles from rain, snow, and sun exposure. This type of facility increases the lifespan of bicycles and improves user comfort and convenience.



Gated Parking

Cost	# Existing	Note
-	**0**	A secure bike storage facility enclosed by a fence or structure and accessible only through a controlled entry point, such as a locked gate, keycard access, or security code.

Bike Racks at UVU

An inventory of campus facilities identified 113 bike racks at UVU, providing secure parking for a combined 393 bicycles (with front wheel racks counted as holding only two bikes each). These racks vary widely in design, including U-racks, lighting racks, wave racks, and front wheel racks.

U-racks are the most effective and preferred option because they are intuitive, provide two points of contact for stability, and allow secure locking with a U-lock. Wave racks offer some flexibility but can be confusing and less user-friendly. Front wheel racks are the least desirable as they can bend spokes and do not accommodate U-locks.

Bike Racks at UVU

113

Bike racks



393

Bike parking spots















Bike Rack Recommendations



Pin	Description	#	Cost Estimate
	Replace front wheel racks with U-racks	22 (44 U-Racks)	$7,040
	Install new U-racks	37	$5,920
	Keller Building Lightning Racks	6	$3,870
★	Additional U-Racks at parking hubs*	15	$2,400
Total:		80	$19,230

Note: Bike racks were not inventoried near the Smith Engineering Building due to construction. Additional racks may be needed after construction.

*Additional costs for the four parking hubs will be needed to add overhead coverings, walls, gates, signage, and other improvements. These costs are not included here since design will vary significantly at each hub.

Replace front wheel racks

Front wheel–only racks offer limited security, as they do not accommodate U-locks, are unstable, more vulnerable to theft, and can damage bicycles. To address this, we recommend replacing the **22 existing front wheel racks** with **2 U-racks each (44 total).** This upgrade, with an estimated cost of $7,040, will provide secure, durable, and user-friendly parking that enhances safety, encourages ridership, and aligns with best practices in modern bicycle infrastructure.

Install new racks where needed

Install short-term bicycle parking at or near all primary building entrances to ensure convenient and consistent bike access across campus. Racks should be clearly visible, well-lit, and located within walking distance of entry points without obstructing pedestrian flow.

- Install at least 1 U-rack at 32 building entrances. **Estimated cost of $5,120**.
- Install 5 U-racks along the guardrail overlooking the UVU Courtyard to serve the central building entrances in this area. **Estimated cost: $800**.
- Install 6 new lighting racks at the Keller Building to match existing lighting racks. **Estimated cost: $3,870**.

UVU COURTYARD



*Additional U-Racks at parking hubs

Install additional bicycle parking in locations that are regularly overcrowded.

- Install 8 additional U-racks at the Library Hub to accommodate expected usage. **Estimated cost: $960**.
- Install 4 additional U-racks at the Parking Garage. **Estimated Cost: $480**.
- Install 5 U-Racks at the proposed East Campus Hub. **Estimated cost: $600**.
- Install new racks where needed

LIBRARY HUB





KELLER BUILDING





Establish covered bike parking hubs

The cost of covered bicycle parking shelters can vary widely depending on factors such as design, style, size, and materials. Basic prefabricated shelters typically start around $10,000–$15,000 for a small structure that covers a handful of racks, while larger or custom-designed shelters with architectural detailing, integrated lighting, or higher-quality materials can range from $25,000 to $50,000 or more. The final cost is highly dependent on the level of weather protection, durability, and aesthetic integration desired for the site.

Provide secure, covered long-term bicycle racks at four locations:



LIBRARY MOBILITY HUB

Install walls and a gate at this northern parking facility adjacent to the library. Gated access is limited to students and faculty via UVU ID.



EAST CAMPUS HUB

Install 5 U-racks on the east side of the Computer Science building to establish a convenient covered bicycle parking hub serving the east side of campus.



SPORTS CENTER

Install shelter for this existing southern parking facility between the Science Building and the adjacent fountain pond. This facility would accommodate sporting event attendees as well as daily users.

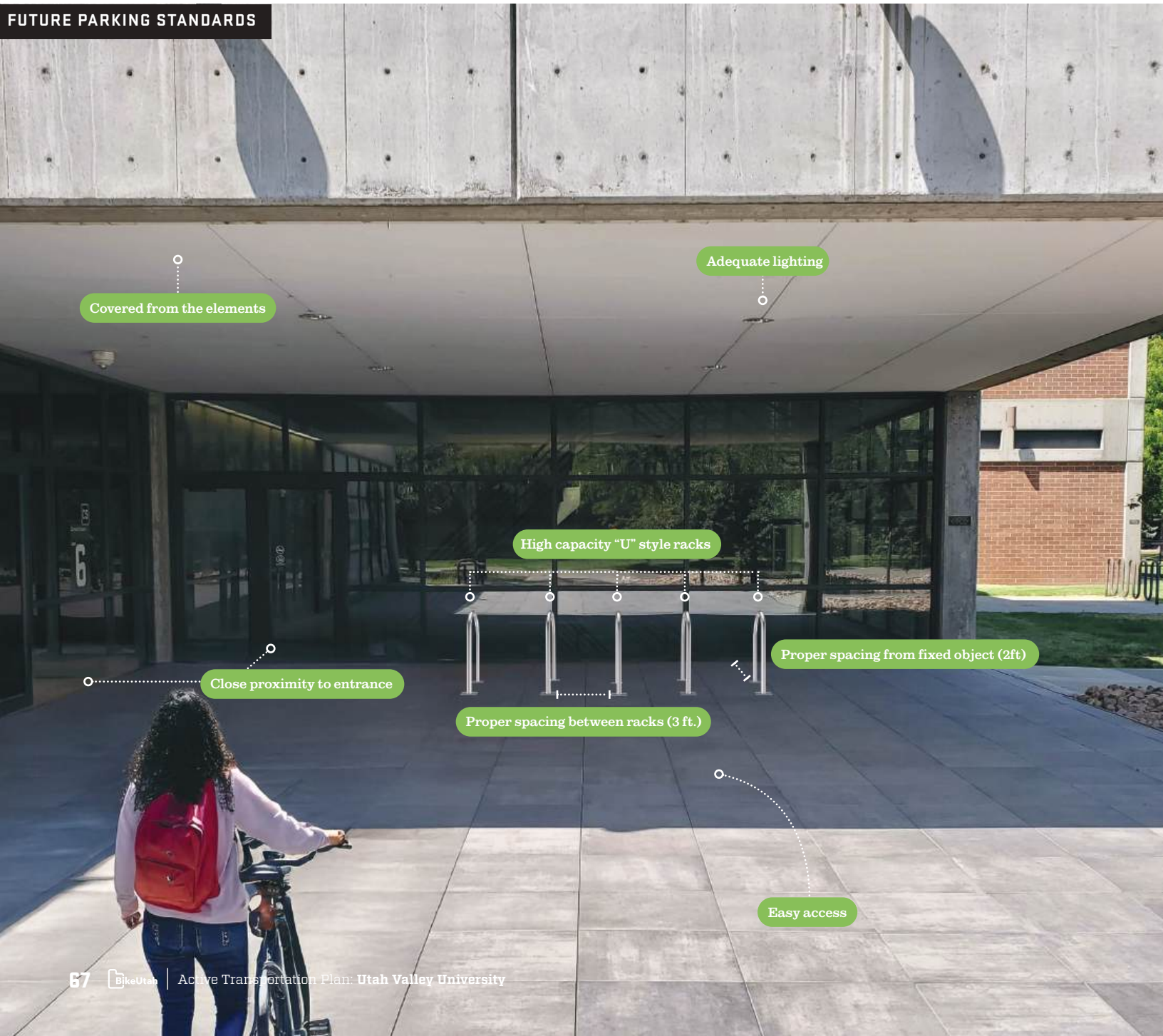


PARKING GARAGE

Improve this central parking facility by installing wayfinding signs to guide and encourage use and adding 4 additional U-racks. Enhance the entrance of the parking facility to improve visibility and create a more intuitive, user-friendly parking experience.

Provide bike rack standards for new buildings

New buildings should incorporate bike parking standards that prioritize functionality, security, and accessibility. **All bike racks must follow the U-rack or similar designs** that support the frame at least two points of contact and allow for secure U-locking of both the frame and wheel. At minimum, one bike rack should be placed near each primary building entrance, positioned to avoid obstructing pedestrian flow while remaining visible and convenient for cyclists. These standards should be formally integrated into construction and site design guidelines to ensure consistent implementation.



Wayfinding

29 New Signs to Guide the UVU Bike Loop

Wayfinding signs provide information that helps people easily navigate campus. Good wayfinding not only directs users to their destinations, but also reinforces campus identity and encourages walking and biking by reducing uncertainty about routes and facilities.

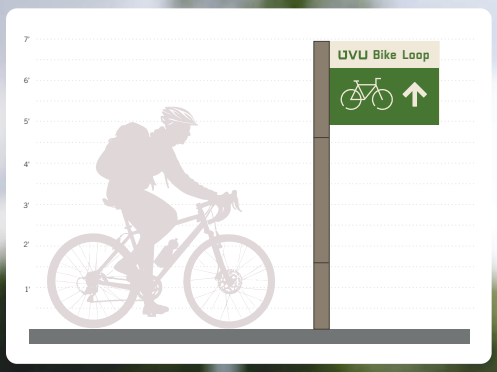
This plan recommends installing 29 new directional signs along the UVU Bike Loop. These signs will help riders navigate the loop and increase awareness of the facility. Signs are located at turns and at connections with internal multi-use paths. Because the loop is bidirectional, two signs are required at each turn to serve both directions of travel. The total estimated cost for these directional signs is approximately $400 each, or about $11,600 in total.

In addition, 4 larger destination signs are recommended at bike parking hubs. Each sign is estimated at $2,000, for a total cost of about $8,000. Combined, the expected cost for all wayfinding signs is approximately $19,600.

Design Considerations:

- **Install signs at entrances** to and decision points along the UVU Bike Loop
- **Place signs on the right side of traffic flow** so they are easily visible to cyclists
- **Avoid placing signs where they will be obstructed** by vegetation, parked cars, or other street amenities.
- **Ensure signs use consistent branding** and are mounted at a consistent height
- **Use reflective materials** for nighttime visibility

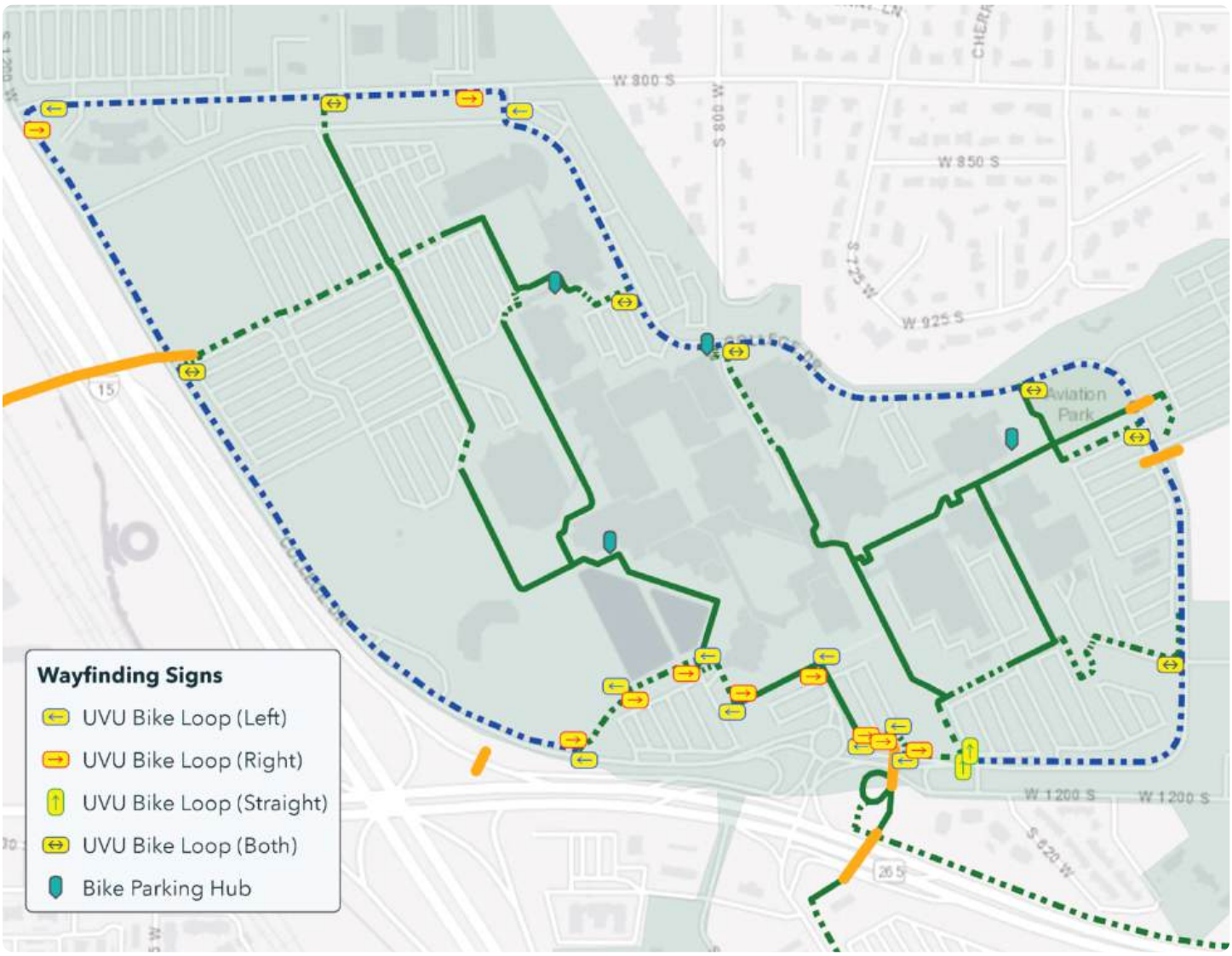
UVU BIKE LOOP WAYFINDING SIGN





Summary of Wayfinding Recommendations

Sign Type	Arrow Direction	#	Cost per sign
UVU Bike Loop	Right	10	$400
	Left	10	
	Straight	2	
	Both Directions	7	
Bike Parking Hubs	n/a	4	$2,000
	Total:	**33**	**$19,600**



Existing Signs

UVU already has wayfinding signs that point to campus buildings, along with maps placed in key locations. These existing signs and maps are effective, but many would benefit from ongoing maintenance to ensure they remain clean, legible, and up to date.







Bike Parking Hubs

UVU should establish four bike parking hubs — covered parking areas strategically located in the north, east, south, and west sides of campus. Each hub should include a destination sign oriented toward the nearest multi-use path to attract cyclists and increase visibility of available parking.

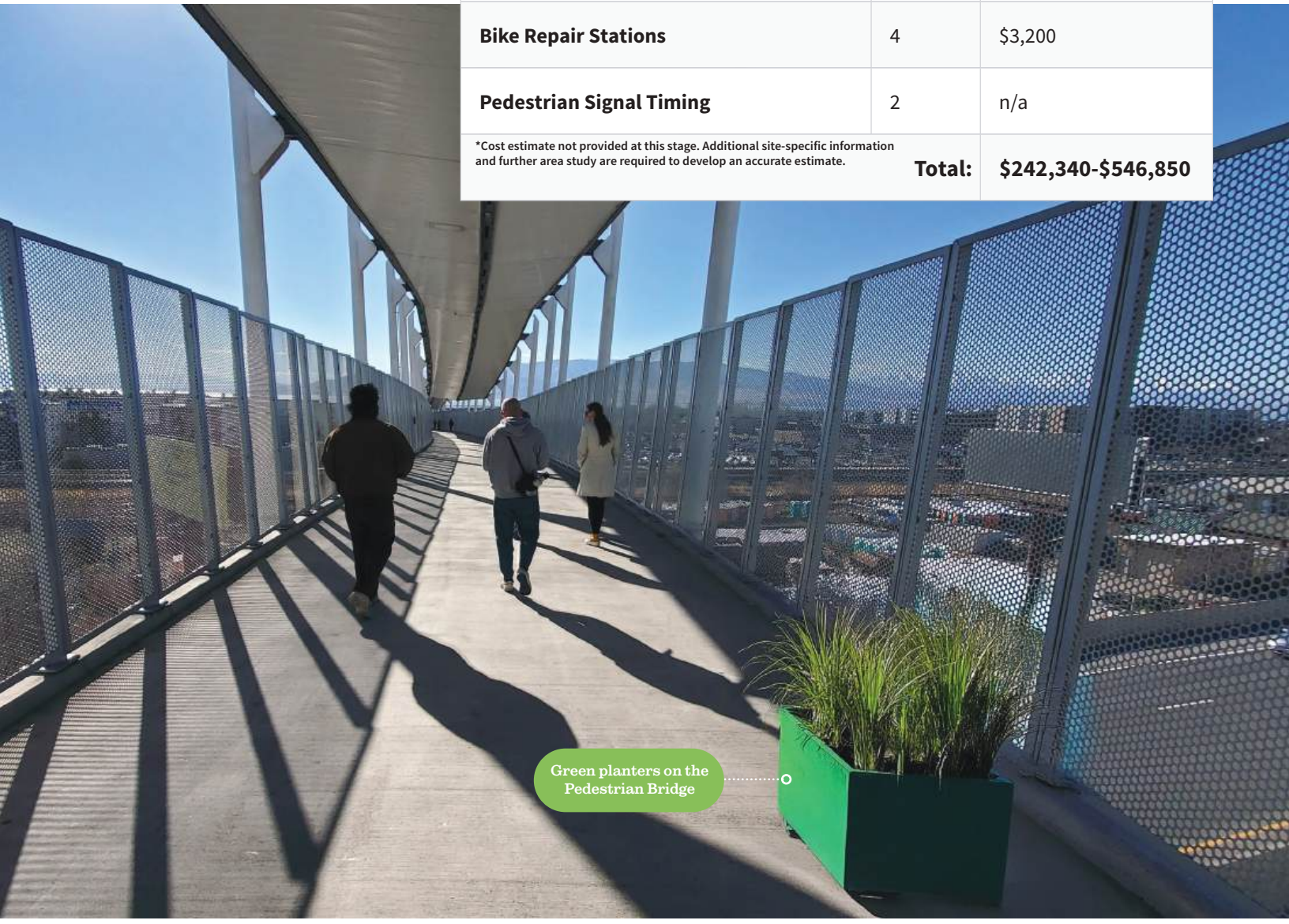


Comfort Improvements

Comfort Improvements

Comfort improvements are important for making walking and biking on campus safe, convenient, and enjoyable. Cost estimates are provided but vary widely since they depend on specific types of features, the scale of installation, and design choices UVU will need to make. For this reason, the plan provides a range of costs to reflect potential options.

Facility Type	#	Cost Estimate
Pedestrian Bridge (bike wheel gutters, hammerglass barriers, green planters)	n/a	$146,000-$308,000
Trees (planting and 4-year maintenance)	~66	$45,540-$133,650
Underpass Murals (total sq. footage)	5	$10,000-$40,000
Bus Stop Improvements	4 shelters 14 maps	$37,600-$62,000
Lighting	n/a	n/a*
Bike Repair Stations	4	$3,200
Pedestrian Signal Timing	2	n/a
*Cost estimate not provided at this stage. Additional site-specific information and further area study are required to develop an accurate estimate.	**Total:**	**$242,340-$546,850**



Green planters on the Pedestrian Bridge

Pedestrian Bridge

The UVU pedestrian bridge is a landmark active-transportation structure spanning over 1,000 feet across I-15, the UTA FrontRunner, and Union Pacific rail lines. Designed to connect the UTA Orem Central Station with UVU's main campus, the bridge stands as a signature investment in active transportation and sustainable connectivity, embodying modern design, safety, and inclusivity while linking vital transit hubs with campus life.

The $30.7 million pedestrian bridge includes 15,000 square feet of heated concrete surface, a walkway featuring 125 lights, 18 security cameras, two elevators, and a fully enclosed structure designed to enhance user safety and comfort. The project was primarily funded by the Utah Department of Transportation (UDOT), which contributed $20.7 million, with additional funding from the Utah Transit Authority (UTA) at $4 million and Utah Valley University (UVU) at $6 million.

UDOT and UTA remain potential funding partners for future enhancements, renovations, or ongoing maintenance of the facility.
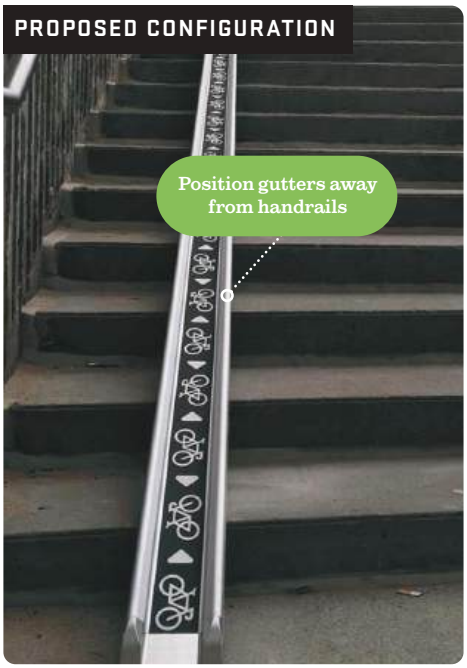


Bike Accessibility

REPLACE BIKE WHEEL GUTTERS to improve usability, convenience, and intuitive design. Position gutters away from handrails to provide better clearance and make it easier for users to guide their bikes up and down stairs.
Cost Estimate: $6,000-$15,000.







Bridge Comfort

INCORPORATE GREEN INFRASTRUCTURE within the bridge, such as integrated planters, green walls, and native vegetation, to reduce noise, enhance aesthetics, and provide shade. **Cost Estimate: $9,000-$26,000**

EXAMPLE



Culver City Crossroads, Feb 24, 2020

EXAMPLE

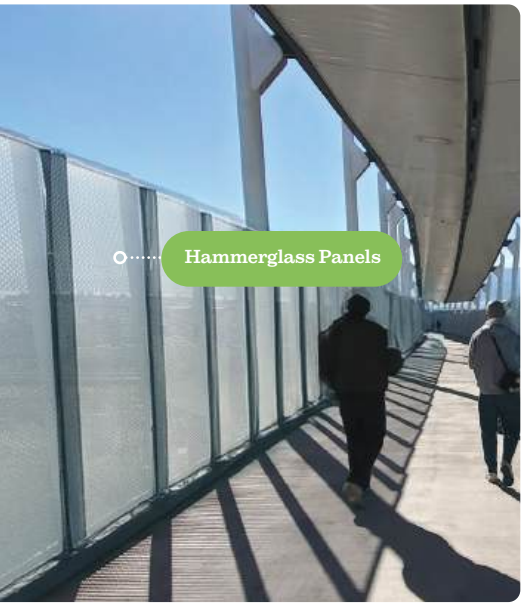


Downtown Bellevue





UPDATE DISPLAY CASES within the bridge more regularly with campus events, marketing information, and community announcements to create an engaging and informative experience for pedestrians.



REPLACE GRATED WALL PANELS WITH TRANSPARENT HAMMERGLASS PANELS or something similar within the central section (directly over freeway) to reduce freeway noise. **Cost Estimate: $131,000-$267,000.**

EXAMPLE



HAMMERGLASS BARRIERS
Hammerglass barriers are a best-practice solution for pedestrian bridges, combining noise reduction with safety, visibility, and durability. Unlike opaque panels, their transparency preserves daylight, reduces the tunnel effect, and improves security. Up to 300 times stronger than glass, resistant to vandalism and weather, and protected from UV and graffiti, hammerglass requires little maintenance. By cutting noise and exhaust while keeping bridges open and inviting, these barriers enhance comfort, safety, and accessibility for people walking and biking.

Trees and Landscaping

Landscaping and green space are essential to supporting active transportation by improving comfort, safety, and the overall user experience. Shaded walkways, trails, and bike routes reduce heat stress and create a pleasant environment for students, faculty, and visitors, while landscaped buffers enhance safety by separating active modes from vehicle traffic.

Landscaping also adds visual interest and strengthens campus identity, transforming corridors into welcoming public spaces. Incorporating xeriscaping with drought-tolerant, low-maintenance plants conserves water, lowers upkeep costs, and ensures long-term sustainability. Together, green space, landscaping, and xeriscaping make walking, biking, and transit more attractive, practical, and resilient on campus.

Successful tree planting depends on pairing water-efficient species with reliable irrigation during establishment. Plan for $500–$1,200 per tree installed and $450–$750 in maintenance during the first 3 years, ensuring shade, cooling, and long-term campus value in the Wasatch Front's hot, dry summers and cold winters. With proper care, 90–95% survival rate after 5 years. Without irrigation/maintenance, mortality may exceed 30%.

Tree Planting Guidelines

- Maintain 3–5 feet setback from sidewalks and 6–10 feet from curbs; avoid conflicts with utilities. Space trees according to mature canopy size: Small trees: ~20 ft apart. Medium trees: ~30 ft apart. Large canopy trees: ~40 ft apart
- Tree purchase costs vary by caliper size, ranging from $125–$200 for 1–1.5" trees, $250–$500 for 2–3" trees (the standard for development), and $800–$1,500 for larger 3.5–4"+ trees that provide an instant canopy. Installation—including soil amendment, labor, staking, and mulch—typically adds $300–$500 per tree, bringing the average installed cost to $500–$1,200 per tree.



Tree maintenance

- Establishment Phase (Years 0–3): Provide weekly summer irrigation (10–20 gallons per tree), apply 2–4 inches of mulch for water retention, and conduct annual pruning and pest monitoring. Estimated cost: $150–$750 per tree per year.
- Post-Establishment (Years 4+): Provide deep irrigation during drought periods (typically once or twice per month in July–August) and conduct structural pruning every 3–5 years. Estimated cost: $40–$75 per tree per year.

Irrigation Practices

- At Planting: Install drip irrigation or watering bags; rainfall is not sufficient for establishment.
- 0–3 Years: Deep watering 1–2x/week during the growing season.
- 4+ Years:
    - Drought-tolerant/native trees (Hackberry, Honeylocust, Oak, Serviceberry) may need water only 1–2x/month in July/August.
    - Non-native shade trees (Maple, Sycamore, Linden) generally require supplemental watering every 2–3 weeks in summer.
- Winter: No irrigation needed once trees go dormant (late Oct–March).



Tree Planting Guidelines

Shade/Canopy Trees:



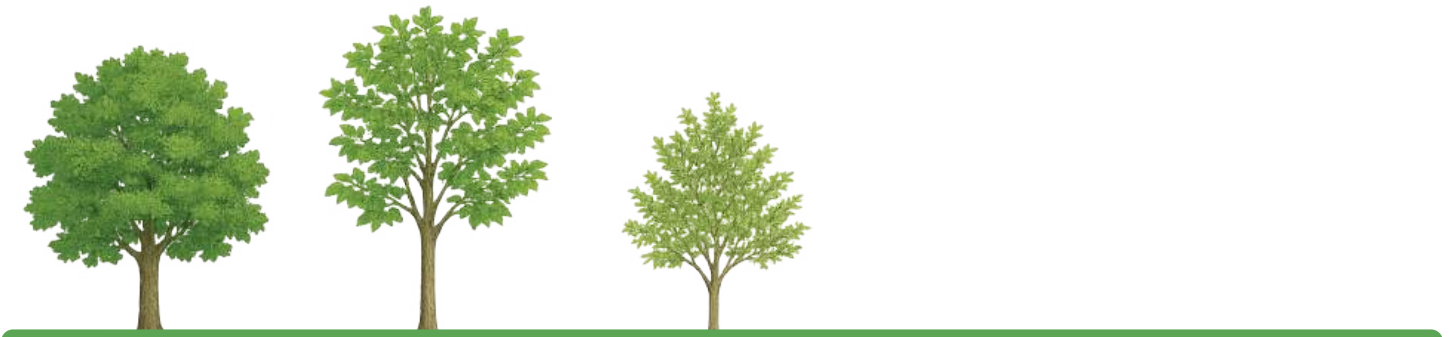
HONEYLOCUST | HACKBERRY | KENTUCKY COFFEE TREE | BUR OAK | NORTHERN CATALPA

Shade/Canopy Trees:



SERVICEBERRY | CRABAPPLE | REDBUD

Native/Drought-Tolerant:



GAMBEL OAK | BOXELDER (SELECT CULTIVARS) | UTAH SERVICEBERRY

Trees and Shade Gaps



Key

1. **800 S**
   Between W College Drive and Campus Drive
   20 trees

2. **W. College Drive**
   Track and Field Office
   6 trees

3. **Clarke Building**
   Campus Drive and Parking Lot
   10 trees

4. **Library yard**
   7 trees

5. **Wetland Drive:**
   Wetland Drive **north** section
   8 trees

   Wetland Drive **south** section
   8 trees

6. **Event Center Drive**
   Across from Clyde Field
   3 trees

7. **Keller Building**
   Segment 9 to segment 10
   4 trees

Trees and Shade Gaps

1 **800 S**
Between W College Drive and Campus Drive
20 trees



2 **W. College Drive**
Track and Field Office
6 trees



3 **Clarke Building**
Campus Drive and Parking Lot
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Trees and Shade Gaps

5 **Wetland Drive:**
Wetland Drive **north** section
8 trees

Wetland Drive **south** section
8 trees



6 **Event Center Drive**
Across from Clyde Field
3 trees



7 **Keller Building**
Segment 9 to segment 10
10 trees



Underpasses

UVU has six underpasses that provide safer and more convenient passage beneath busy roads. Some of these underpasses have artwork on their walls, but many do not.

The problem

Students report that these spaces often feel dark, uninviting, and at times unsafe, limiting their effectiveness as welcoming active transportation routes.



Keller Building underpass



Solutions

INCORPORATE ARTWORK INTO ALL UNDERPASSES to transform these spaces from dark, utilitarian corridors into inviting and visually engaging environments. Partner with local and UVU student artists to create murals to support community identity and local talent. This will enhance the perceived safety, comfort, and overall user experience for pedestrians and cyclists. Cost **Estimate of one mural (both walls and ceiling): $2,000-$8,000.**

ENSURE UNDERPASS LIGHTING IS INVITING and well-maintained to enhance visibility, safety, and comfort for all users.

EXAMPLES OF GOOD UNDERPASSES



Village of Glen Ellyn

EXAMPLES OF GOOD UNDERPASSES



Port Huron Downtown Development

Bus Stops

Bus stops should prioritize safety, comfort, and accessibility to encourage ridership and create seamless connections with walking and cycling. Comfortable waiting environments reduce perceived travel time, while clear wayfinding lowers barriers for new riders and ensures smoother integration with walking and biking networks.


UVU Gunther Building (NB)


Wolverine Crossing (EB)


UVU McKay Education Building (WB)


UVU Testing services (WB)





Solutions

INSTALL WEATHER PROTECTED SHELTERS with durable and comfortable benches at each bus stop. Design should consider wind, shade, and sun exposure. **Cost Estimate: $8,000-$12,000 each.**

INSTALL BRIGHT, ENERGY-EFFICIENT LIGHTING and, where possible, incorporate passive surveillance through visibility from nearby land uses.

INCLUDE TRANSIT SYSTEM MAPS AND DIGITAL DISPLAYS or QR codes/links with live updates for bus arrival times. Include timetables for each route such as first/last trip times (“Weekdays: 5:30 AM – 11:00 PM”) and frequency indicators (“Buses every 15 minutes”). These improvements allow passengers to quickly assess where they are, which bus route will take them to their destination, and when the next bus will arrive. **Cost Estimate: $400-$1,000 each.**

Lighting

Lighting is a critical factor in making walking, biking, and transit routes on UVU's main campus safe, comfortable, and inviting. While existing lighting generally provides visibility, many fixtures create a cold, harsh atmosphere that can feel unwelcoming at night. In addition, flickering or non-functioning bulbs and dark spots between buildings reduce safety and limit the usability of active transportation facilities after daylight hours.





Solutions

REPLACE FAULTY FIXTURES to address all flickering and non-functioning bulbs.

TRANSITION TO WARM LED LIGHTING (ideally in the 2700K–3000K range) to provide an inviting, comfortable atmosphere while maintaining visibility and reducing glare.

STANDARDIZE BULB TYPE across campus to ensure consistency, ease of replacement, and predictable lighting quality.

CONDUCT A LIGHTING AUDIT TO IDENTIFY DARK SPOTS along major pedestrian walkways, bike routes, transit stops, and building entrances, and add fixtures where needed.

INSTALL SHIELDED LIGHTING to reduce light pollution, direct illumination downward, and improve nighttime safety while preserving dark skies.

Bike Repair Station

Install bike repair stations at the four bike parking hubs, providing tools and air pumps for students in need. These typically cost around **$800 per station**.





Pedestrian Signal Timing at intersections

Current signal phasing at the two intersections on 800 S (1200 W and Campus Drive) permits left-turning vehicle movements to conflict with pedestrians in the crosswalk, creating safety and comfort concerns.

- Modify signal timing and/or incorporate Leading Pedestrian Intervals to reduce conflicts and improve pedestrian safety. According to FHWA best practices, LPIs have been shown to decrease pedestrian-vehicle collisions by up to 60%, making them an effective tool for advancing safe and accessible active transportation networks.



CHAPTER

05 Implementation Plan



Next Steps

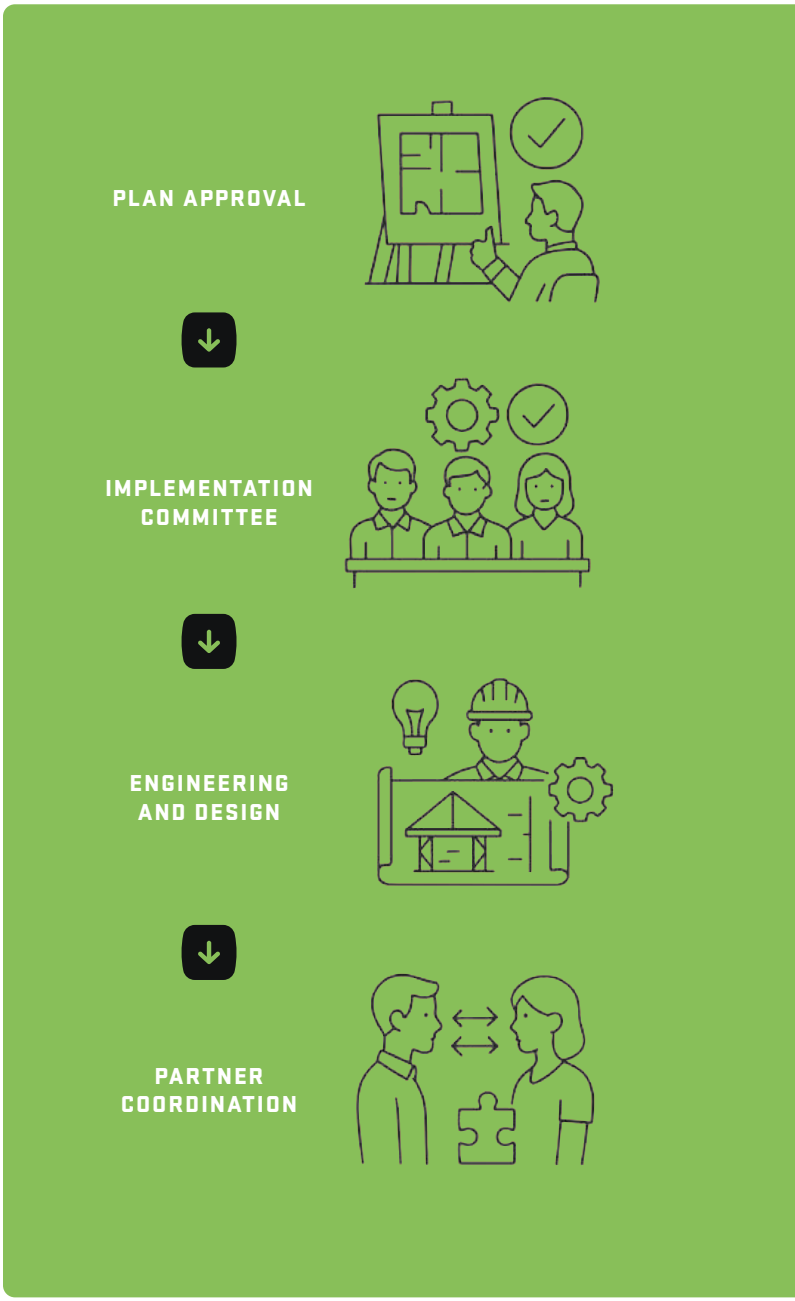
This final chapter outlines implementation strategies for Utah Valley University to follow including immediate next steps, project prioritization, policies and programs to support and encourage active transportation on campus, maintenance guidance, and potential funding sources.

- **PLAN APPROVAL**
  This plan should be formally adopted by UVU administration and relevant campus committees. Adoption will establish this plan as a guiding document for campus improvements, ensuring recommendations are considered in facilities planning and external coordination.

- **IMPLEMENTATION COMMITTEE**
  UVU should establish a committee or working group to oversee implementation of this plan. This group will follow through on implementation actions, prioritize projects, resolve issues, and monitor progress. Membership should include UVU representatives as well as external partners from Orem City, MAG, UDOT, and UTA.

- **ENGINEERING AND DESIGN**
  While this plan provides high-level recommendations for facilities, additional planning is required before projects are construction ready. UVU should contract with a design firm to complete detailed engineering for the UVU Bike Loop, multi-use paths, and 4 bike parking hubs. This step will refine alignments, confirm feasibility, and produce more accurate cost estimates.

- **PARTNER COORDINATION**
  Some recommended improvements are planned on right-of-way not owned entirely by UVU, such as 800 S and College Dr. Other recommendations refer to external connections extending well beyond the campus boundary, including on 960 S, 1200 S, 1200 W, 800 W, Sandhill Rd, University Pkwy, and Geneva Rd. Coordination with Orem City, MAG, UDOT, and UTA will be needed to implement these improvements. See Chapters 3 and 4 for more details.



Implementation Timeline

This section provides a general timeline for implementing capital improvement projects and other recommendations, broken down into **short-, medium-, and long-term** actions. This timeline is intended to be flexible depending on funding, partnerships, permitting, and site-specific conditions.

Short-term (0-2 years)	
Category	**Actions**
Planning	• Establish an implementation committee. • Contract with a design and engineering firm to develop construction-ready designs for the UVU Bike Loop, multi-use paths, and bike parking hubs. • Incorporate multi-use path and bike rack standards into campus guidelines for new construction. • Work with partners to incorporate projects on shared right-of-way and external connections within their capital improvement plans and budgets.
Bike Parking	• Replace 22 front wheel racks with 44 U-racks. • Install 58 new U-racks. • Add bike parking areas to campus wayfinding signs and online campus maps where feasible.
Comfort Improvements	• Replace bike ramp channels on the stairs at the I-15 pedestrian bridge. Work with UDOT to plan and implement additional pedestrian bridge comfort improvements. • Plant ~66 new trees on campus. Develop tree maintenance plan. • Paint 5 murals on unpainted underpasses (in coordination with UDOT as needed). • Conduct a lighting audit to identify lighting improvement needs throughout campus. • Coordinate with UTA to improve transit frequency and station/stop comfort where feasible.
Policies & Programs	• Develop initiatives to support and encourage active commuting (see Policies & Programs on page 88).

Medium-term (3-5 years)	
Category	**Actions**
Bike Parking	• Construct 4 bike parking hubs including overhead shelters, entrance improvements, walls/gates, wayfinding, bike repair stations, and other improvements as needed.
Campus Facilities	• Construct UVU Bike Loop on 800 S, Campus Dr, and College Dr. • Construct multi-use path improvements throughout campus.

Long-term (5-10 years)	
Category	**Actions**
Planning	• Address active transportation needs related to new construction on campus. • Consider active transportation connections to UVU Geneva Campus in Vineyard. • Update this Active Transportation Plan as needed.

Policies and Programs

Additional UVU policies and programs may help to support and encourage active transportation on campus. These tools complement infrastructure by embedding supportive behaviors and institutional norms into campus life.



UVU-UTA Transit Pass

UVU already provides students, faculty, and staff with free access to UTA services through their campus ID, along with dependent passes available for spouses and children under 24. UVU should continue to support and promote this benefit.



Campus Events

UVU hosts Walk and Roll to Campus Day each August and Bike to Work (or Anywhere) Day each May to encourage walking, biking, and rolling to campus. These events feature music, giveaways, and partner tabling. UVU should continue and expand these efforts through activities such as commuter challenges or group rides.



Free Bike Tune-Ups

Consider offering free bike tune-ups for students and employees. This could be through the UVU Outdoor Adventure Center or provided at a special bike maintenance event once a semester.



Bike Education & Advice

Provide information on safe biking routes to UVU, bike parking locations, public transit options, and relevant state and local laws through online guides, orientation materials, or workshops hosted by the UVU Outdoor Adventure Center. Practical guidance helps new riders feel confident and reduces barriers to active transportation.



Incentives for Active Commuters

Provide incentives to reward students and employees who walk, bike, or take transit instead of driving. This might include prize drawings, discounts at campus stores/dining, or vouchers to local bike shops. Participation can be tracked through online surveys with photo verification, QR codes or ID scanners at bike parking hubs, or mobile apps like Strava, RideAmigos, or Luum.



Theft Prevention and Registration

Develop a campus program for reporting stolen bikes, scooters, skateboards, and other transportation devices. This can be complimented with free registration that comes with a unique registration sticker. Registration helps with recovery and also deters theft.



Bike Valet

Include free bike valet service as a standard practice for major events. These services offer a secure, convenient, and highly visible option for attendees who bike or roll. Valet services can often be sponsored by local organizations such as Bike Orem, making them more cost-effective and community-driven.



Regional Bike Share Program

While UVU's campus is too small to support a stand-alone bike share system, the university can coordinate with local governments to participate in a broader program with Orem, Vineyard, and Provo cities.

Maintenance Guidance

Ongoing maintenance is critical to ensure active transportation facilities remain safe, attractive, and usable. At UVU, the Campus Services Department is responsible for operations and maintenance on campus. While additional multi-use paths and bike amenities will add to their workload (and more funding will be needed), they already have the necessary equipment and expertise to accomplish these tasks.

Key tasks include sweeping and cleaning paths, managing trees and vegetation, removing snow and ice, replacing and repairing signs and amenities, and addressing lighting or safety concerns. Timely maintenance is especially important during snow events to ensure facilities remain accessible and are seen as reliable options for students and staff year-round.



Multi-Use Paths

Additional paths will require the same routine care already provided for existing paths, including sweeping, clearing snow, and monitoring pavement condition.



UVU Bike Loop

The UVU Bike Loop is a new facility type for campus and will require developing a maintenance plan. At 12 feet wide, its needs will be similar to multi-use paths and likely compatible with existing equipment.



AT Amenities

Bike racks may need to be tightened or replaced over time, while bike repair stations should be checked regularly to ensure pumps and tools are in working order. Lighting should be monitored to ensure all bulbs remain functional. Visible, well-maintained amenities signal that UVU supports biking and help prevent deterioration that could discourage use.



Wayfinding Signs

Many existing wayfinding signs on campus are faded, highlighting a need for more consistent upkeep. Signs should be periodically cleaned, and replacement schedules should be established to ensure legibility and brand consistency. Well-maintained signs contribute to campus identity and help users navigate confidently.



Trees and Vegetation

Trees and landscaping along active transportation corridors require attentive care, particularly in the first three years after planting when establishment is most critical. Regular watering, pruning, and monitoring for disease or damage will ensure healthy growth and shade benefits over the long term.



Pedestrian Bridge & Underpasses

These routes will need regular cleaning, graffiti removal, and lighting maintenance to ensure they remain clean, safe, and welcoming. Adding public art or design elements can further enhance comfort and identity.



UTA Stops

UVU should coordinate with UTA to ensure nearby stops remain clean, accessible, and inviting. Bus stop amenities can be installed or improved through partnership efforts.

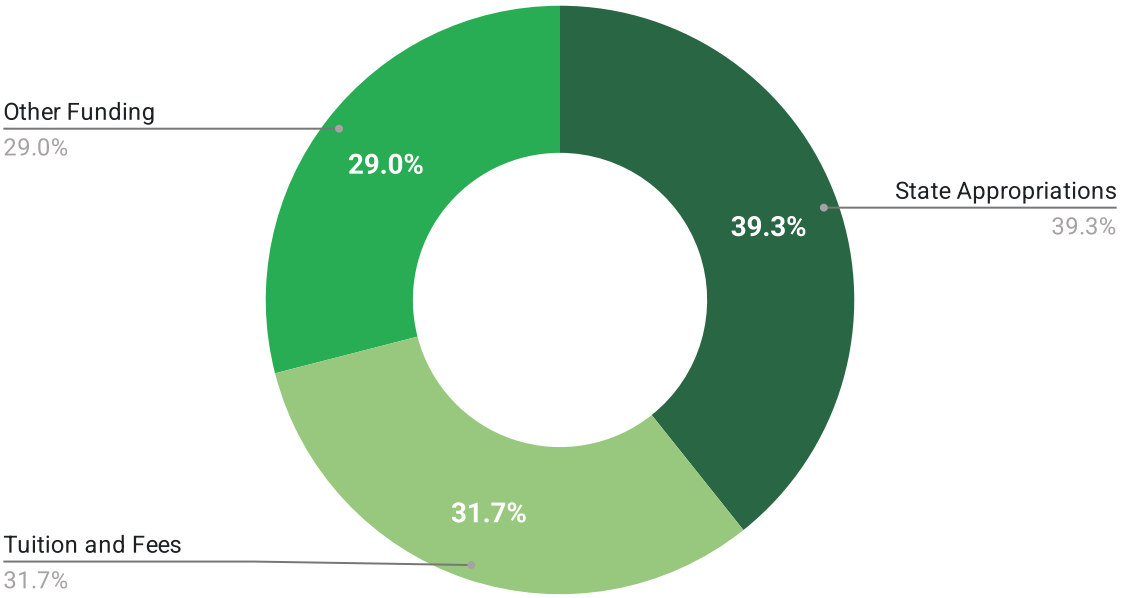
Funding Source

Big Return

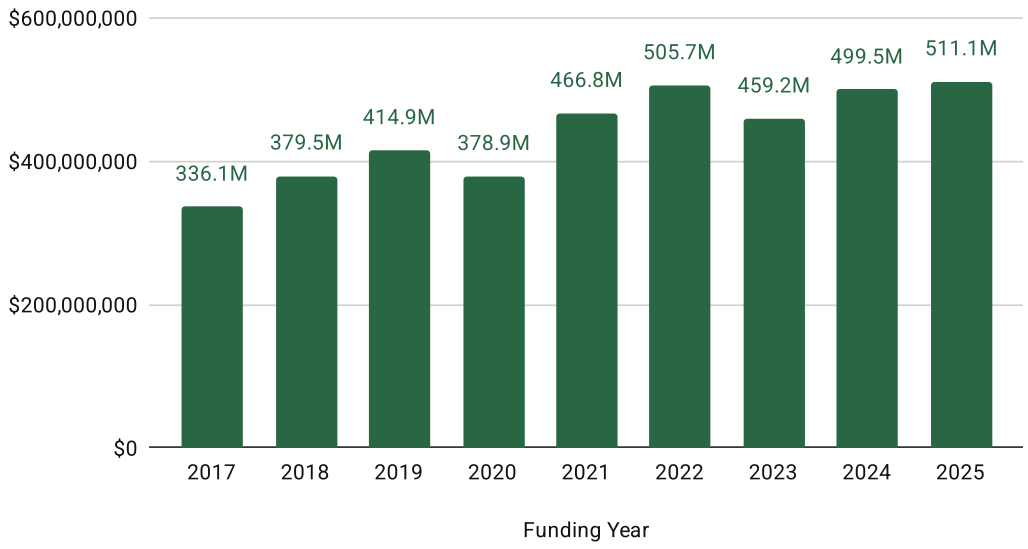
This plan's recommended improvements are estimated to cost around $3.628 million. This investment is less than 1% of UVU's total annual budget, while offering significant benefits to safety, accessibility, and campus life.

For context, UVU's total funding for FY2025 was over $511 million, a figure that has gradually increased over recent years in line with student enrollment growth. Of this budget, 39% comes from state appropriations, 32% from tuition and fees, and 29% from other funding sources.

UVU Funding Sources (2025)



UVU Annual Budget (2017-2025)



Internal Funding

The primary mechanism for funding active transportation improvements on campus will be UVU's own internal funding sources:

- **CAPITAL PLANNING AND FACILITIES**
  Large-scale projects such as new multi-use paths, the UVU Bike Loop, and bike parking hubs can be incorporated into UVU's capital planning and facility annual budget.
- **STUDENT FEES**
  Many universities dedicate small student fees to support sustainability or transportation improvements. UVU may consider allocating such funds toward capital improvements or ongoing programs like bike tune-ups or commuter incentives.
- **DEPARTMENTAL CONTRIBUTIONS**
  Certain amenities may be supported directly by departments. For example, Athletics may help fund bike valet services for events, while the Sustainability Office could support bike education programs.

Grants & Private Partnerships

UVU may benefit from external grants and private support for specific projects:

- **FEDERAL GRANTS (VIA PARTNERS)**
  While UVU cannot typically apply directly for federal transportation funds, projects can be included in applications led by local government partners. This may include TAP, CMAQ, RTP, SS4A, and other grants.
- **PRIVATE OR COMMUNITY SPONSORS**
  Certain amenities like bike valets, racks, or repair stations can be sponsored by local businesses, nonprofits, philanthropic organizations, community groups, or private donors. Sponsorship reduces the cost burden on UVU while strengthening partnerships with local stakeholders.

Cost Sharing with Partners

Because UVU's transportation system connects directly to the surrounding city and region, many improvements will require coordination and shared funding with external partners:

- **OREM CITY**
  Orem owns and maintains several roads adjacent to campus including 800 S, College Dr, and Sandhill Rd. They will be a key partner in constructing and maintaining improvements on these roads.
- **MOUNTAINLAND ASSOCIATION OF GOVERNMENTS (MAG)** As a regional planning organization, MAG often funds regional active transportation projects (including this plan). They will be a key partner on future UVU AT investments.
- **UTAH DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (UDOT)** Improvements along state-owned roads near campus, namely University Parkway, will need UDOT approval and will likely be funded in part by UDOT. They also own the I-15 pedestrian bridge and will be a key partner on any bridge improvements.
- **UTAH TRANSIT AUTHORITY (UTA)**
  UTA can assist with improvements to bus stops, UVX stations, and the Orem Central FrontRunner Station.
- **UTAH STATE LEGISLATURE**
  UVU may consider submitting a one-time budget request to the legislature during the legislative session for specific capital improvements.